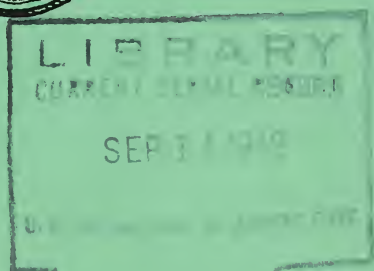


84M
Department of Agriculture

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK



Miscellaneous Publication No. 690
U. S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

THE UNITED STATES

DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

Sec. Office of the Secretary.

BAE: Bureau of Agricultural Economics.

B & F: Office of Budget and Finance.

OHE: Office of Hearing Examiners.

Inf.: Office of Information.

Lib.: Library.

OFAR: Office of Foreign Agriculture Relations.

Pers.: Office of Personnel.

P & O: Office of Plant and Operations.

RMA: Office of Administrator, Research and Marketing Act.

Sol.: Office of the Solicitor.

ARA: Agricultural Research Administration.

AIC: Bureau of Agricultural and Industrial Chemistry.

BAI: Bureau of Animal Industry.

ARC: Agricultural Research Center.

BDI: Bureau of Dairy Industry.

EPQ: Bureau of Entomology and Plant Quarantine.

OES: Office of Experiment Stations.

HNHE: Bureau of Human Nutrition and Home Economics:

PISAE: Bureau of Plant Industry, Soils and Agricultural Engineering.

CCC: Commodity Credit Corporation.

CEA: Commodity Exchange Authority.

Ext.: Extension Service.

FCA: Farm Credit Administration.

FCIC: Federal Crop Insurance Corporation.

FHA: Farmers Home Administration.

FS: Forest Service:

PMA: Production and Marketing Administration.

REA: Rural Electrification Administration.

SCS: Soil Conservation Service.

Department of Agriculture

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK



Miscellaneous Publication No. 690

Supersedes Miscellaneous Publication No. 532

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE
OFFICE OF PERSONNEL

UNITED STATES
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FOREWORD

All of us who serve the American people through this great Department carry a heavier responsibility than ever before.

The skill and strength of purpose which we devote to our jobs will help to determine whether this Nation can learn to live with the abundance produced by American farmers and whether agriculture will continue to be a strong girder under our national prosperity and security.

This Department, in one sense, is no more than the people who work for it. It must renew itself with young and new personnel, and each person must have certain basic information so that we can all work together as a team.

This handbook presents many of the facts that all of us need in order to be good workers. I hope we will all read and refer to it often. It will help us to carry out our duties with the efficiency that the American people have learned to expect from us.


Secretary of Agriculture.

WASHINGTON, D. C.

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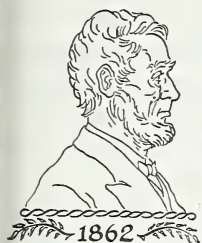
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YOUR DEPARTMENT, HOW IT STARTED, HOW IT WORKS



The Department of Agriculture was born in a war. President Lincoln signed the act establishing Agriculture as an independent bureau under a Commissioner May 15, 1862. At that time there was a shortage of farm labor and an unprecedented demand for production. An important source of money and good will for the North was the export of wheat to England. The Government wished to

encourage farmers in every way possible. The Civil War Congress also passed the Homestead Act, opening western farm lands to settlers on easier terms, and the Morrill Land-Grant College Act, granting to each State sections of unsettled territory for the endowment of agricultural colleges.

The Federal Government had been interested in improving agriculture, however, long before 1862. The North America of the Indians had been largely forest, with few native food plants. Franklin, Washington, Jefferson, and other early leaders urged the collection of improved species of plants and animals that would grow here. Washington prized especially a gift from the King of Spain, a jackass which became the ancestor of many American mules, and John Quincy Adams made the collection of rare seeds a regular task of our foreign representatives.

Henry Ellsworth, Commissioner of Patents, 1836-44, first began distributing plants and seeds to farmers, largely at his own expense. In 1839, Congress gave Commissioner Ellsworth permission to expend \$1,000 of Patent Office funds for agricultural purposes—the first specific appropriation for agriculture.

The great need of the farmer after the Civil War was scientific information—how to combat pests and diseases, how to increase the fertility of soil, how to grow two blades of grass instead of one. He could usually sell all he could raise, and at a good price. England and northern Europe bought American cotton, grain, and meat. Foreign money helped build the railroads which carried these products to Atlantic ports, and our farm crops paid the interest on the investment. The Department gradually assembled a staff of scientific experts to

experiment on farm problems. In 1889, the Commissioner became the Secretary of Agriculture and became a member of the President's Cabinet.

Research activities continued to grow. Today most of them are grouped in the Agricultural Research Administration, which includes the Bureaus of Animal Industry; Plant Industry, Soils, and Agricultural Engineering; Dairy Industry; Human Nutrition and Home Economics; Entomology and Plant Quarantine; Agricultural and Industrial Chemistry; Office of Experiment Stations; the Agricultural Research Center, Beltsville, Md.; and nine Bankhead-Jones laboratories scattered over the States. The Research Center is located just outside Washington, and there the Department owns several thousand acres of farm land and has built great laboratories, barns, and central offices for experimental work. Much research is also carried on in the Forest Service, Soil Conservation Service, Federal stations and laboratories, also at State colleges throughout the country, with many of which the Department cooperates through its Office of Experiment Stations. Under the Research and Marketing Act of 1946, much research is also carried on by projects developed by BAE, PMA, FCA, OFAR, ARA, and Extension Service and approved by RMA.

Some research achievements have been immensely valuable. In 1889, California orange orchards were dying under the attack of the fluted scale. A Department entomologist discovered in New Zealand a species of ladybug that fed upon the scale; he brought a few here, where they bred rapidly and practically eliminated the scale in a few years. Disease-resistant strains of sugarcane, lettuce, corn, and cotton; control methods for cattle fever, hog cholera, and other livestock diseases; and sprays, aerosols, powders, and gases to destroy lice and insects are among the achievements of Department scientists.

By 1890, the good farm lands of the West had been largely settled, and the country began to talk about conservation. That year the Government set aside the first national forest reserves. The Forest Service was set up to care for them; in 1905, under Secretary Wilson, it was placed in the Department of Agriculture. As more people moved into cities and business took over food canning and processing, consumers found it impossible to check intelligently on the quality of food products, and demanded Federal regulation and inspection. Between 1905 and 1912, a number of regulatory laws—the Food and Drug Act, for instance—were passed and the responsibility for their enforcement was placed on the Department of Agriculture.

The drift of population to the cities continued, and there was fear that too few farmers would be left to grow food. In 1914, the Extension Service was set up to cooperate with States in education, home improvement, and other services for rural families.

In the First World War the United States became a world bread basket, feeding Allied armies and our own, and later, the people starving in devastated regions. Prices rose, new lands were brought into cultivation, and with the help of modern farm machinery American farmers produced as never before. At the end of the war foreign demand for our food products fell disastrously. Up to 1914 the United States had been a "debtor nation"; that is, foreign investments in this country exceeded our investments abroad, and we owed a balance of interest payments to other countries each year. During the war we loaned so much money to the nations of Europe that we became a "creditor nation," and they now found it difficult to finance purchases from us. For a time we kept our trade going with loans, but repayments proved impossible, and after the 1929 crash there was almost no foreign demand for our farm products. Many farmers had borrowed money in the 1914-18 period to buy more land; they were now unable to repay their mortgages, or even make expenses. The farm quarter of our population got 21 percent of the national income in 1919; in 1921, it received less than 10 percent.

Through the 1920's Congress had debated legislation to help the farmers. In 1933 it initiated a new program designed to adjust farm production to need and markets—the Agricultural Adjustment Act. This was soon followed by the Soil Conservation Act, which emphasizes the improvement of soils. The Farm Security Administration, now the Farmers Home Administration, which provides supervised credit through production loans, farm-ownership loans, and water-facility loans for farmers who can not get the credit they need elsewhere at adequate terms and under reasonable conditions, was established. Congress also sought to increase domestic consumption by encouraging United States citizens to make good use of more food. The Agricultural Marketing Services was developed for this, and the Federal Surplus Commodities Corporation carried out active programs of school lunches and distribution of food through the stamp plan. To prevent high prices in lean-production years, the Ever-Normal Granary was set up to keep on hand sufficient quantities of food to meet emergencies; these stocks helped supply war needs. Farm Credit Administration, Federal Crop Insurance Corporation, and Commodity Credit Corporation grew up in the 1930's to facilitate farm adjustments to these new situations. Rural Electrification Administration, which has already provided loans resulting in the electrification of over a million farms, also had its origin in this period.

During the Second World War the Secretary of Agriculture had charge of the Agricultural Research Administration, the Rural Electrification Administration, the Farm Credit Administration, and the Forest Service. The remaining Department agencies were grouped for

emergency administrative purposes into the War Food Administration, headed by a War Food Administrator appointed by and responsible to the President. The staff agencies served the Department and the Administration as required.

The War Food Administration was abolished by Executive Order on June 29, 1945, its functions and agencies being transferred to the Department of Agriculture. The Secretary of Agriculture thereupon appointed a Committee on Reorganization to consolidate and integrate Department agencies and avoid overlapping, duplication of functions, and inefficient service to the public.

A major announcement made on August 18, 1945, consolidated some 14 Department agencies into a Production and Marketing Administration. Minor additional changes were announced subsequently, and the Department now consists of the following research and program agencies: Agricultural Research Administration, Extension Service, Farm Credit Administration, Farmers Home Administration, Forest Service, Production and Marketing Administration, Rural Electrification Administration, Soil Conservation Service, Federal Crop Insurance Corporation and Commodity Exchange Authority.

The various Department bureaus and administrations are serviced by a number of staff offices, some of which are grouped in the Office of the Secretary. These provide space allotments, financial administration, personnel administration, legal advice, library facilities, and a number of other essential aids to efficient work. The Bureau of Agricultural Economics correlates planning and advises on basic Department programs. The Office of Information helps create the movies, radio and press releases, bulletins, and other publications that carry the results of Department research, planning, and achievement to the public. The Office of Foreign Agricultural Relations provides Department contact with foreign agricultural activities of interest to both official and private agencies.

The Department is an integrated unit in which we all contribute to each other. It has grown as our country has grown, from a handful of employees in Washington (in 1868 there were 47) to our present total of over 72,000 with offices in nearly every county of the United States and representatives throughout the world. No one bureau, office, or job can be classified as more important than any other. Whether we file papers, test soils, write bulletins, or oversee foreign shipments, we are all pushing through to one objective: A higher standard of living for all of our citizens—a virile democracy which can lead the world to the ways of peace.

Neither the benefits obtained from our great Department's work nor the difficulties that we should endure were it stopped can be reckoned. Certainly, the Department of Agriculture is building

enduring values into our civilization. If the past is a true gage of the future the Department will become increasingly important for agriculture and as an influence for national welfare.



YOUR JOB



The act of Congress which established the Department of Agriculture in 1862 directed it to “* * * acquire and diffuse * * * useful information on subjects connected with agriculture in the most general and comprehensive sense of that word.” Since that time, it has grown until it is now one of the largest Departments in Government, with many divisions, offices, agencies, and bureaus.

We are proud of the work we do in the Department of Agriculture. Standards of efficiency are high. We like to work hard, and we like to work together. The operations of the Department are so big and so complex that once you are placed, you may find it hard to feel the importance of your job to the whole organization. But the work you do is essential to smooth and effective operation.



Job description.—Your job is part of the organization plan of the Department. When Congress passes a law dealing with farm problems it usually directs the Department of Agriculture to administer it. The new law is then studied by Department officials; and specialists, stenographers, clerks and other personnel are organized to carry out its provisions.

Before you were officially assigned to your position, a careful description of your duties was written by your bureau or agency, usually in collaboration with the classification analysts of the Department Office of Personnel. Your job description states just what these duties may be—answering the telephone, taking simple dictation,

directing the work of a division of the Department, or advising the Secretary on matters of policy.

A copy of this job description is given to *each* employee on or attached to his official notification of appointment (Form SF-50). You should study this statement carefully and discuss it with your supervisor. Your particular duties may be modified as you progress in experience and ability, or as the work of your organization changes.

Your supervisor.—Everyone in the Federal service has an administrative supervisor. He will explain your work to you or designate someone to do so. He wants to help you do the best possible job, for he is responsible for directing your work.

Job classification.—Jobs are classified according to duties and responsibilities assigned and the knowledge and ability required for their performance. The designations of P, SP, CAF, and CPC are explained as follows:

P stands for the professional and scientific services.

SP stands for the subprofessional services. These employees assist the professional and scientific (P) workers.

CAF stands for the clerical, administrative, and fiscal services.

CPC stands for crafts, protective, and custodial services. It includes messengers, mechanics, janitors, watchmen and maintenance workers of all kinds.

If you have questions about your job classification or your type of appointment ask your supervisor or someone in your personnel office.

Hours of work.—The usual workweek for employees of the Department consists of 5 days of 8 hours each, from Monday, through Friday. In some cases it is necessary to have a different schedule because of local conditions. Time of starting and ending the work day varies in different locations and occasionally because of the kind of work involved. If for some good reason you are unable to come to work, or are delayed beyond starting time, telephone your supervisor promptly.

Overtime.—Work in excess of 40 hours a week is "overtime" work. The Department tries to do its job during the usual working hours. When a peak load of work is carried by an office, when important work is behind schedule, or in emergencies where lives or property are at stake, occasional overtime may be required.

Holidays.—There are eight regular holidays each year for employees of the Department. These are New Year's Day, Washington's Birthday, Decoration Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Armistice Day, Thanksgiving Day, and Christmas. Inauguration Day is also a holiday for employees in the District of Columbia. In addition to closing on holidays, the Department is sometimes closed by administrative order. In the field service this occasionally happens because work cannot be carried on properly because of a local holiday.

PAY



When?—Every 2 weeks on set pay days. When the regular pay day is not a workday payments are made on the preceding workday. Generally there is a lag of 12 days in the first pay day of employees. Pay rolls cannot be certified until after work is completed for the period for which paid. If you start to work at the beginning of a pay period you may not receive your first pay for 25 or 26 days. You may get your money sooner, however, if the money is urgently needed, by submitting a request for a special pay roll. Ask your supervisor about this if you are interested. After you receive your first pay check you will ordinarily be paid each 2 weeks thereafter.

How?—Usually by check. For their convenience, some Washington employees are paid in cash. Arrange to collect it promptly. Checks can be held for you only a few days; cash must be sent back to the Treasury, and a check issued in its place.

If you want your check mailed to you while you are away, consult your supervisor or pay-roll clerk. Some bureaus have special forms for this purpose. It may also be possible to arrange for your check to be sent directly to your bank for deposit.

How much?—The amount depends primarily upon your classification grade. Positions in the Government departments are assigned to classes and grades (for example, statistical clerk, grade CAF-4) upon the basis of their duties, responsibilities, and qualification requirements. A pay scale for each grade is set by law. The pay scales for the various grades under the Classification Act are shown in the table on page 9.

New employees are paid the beginning rate shown for their grade. Their advancement to the higher salary steps in the grade is based on length of service and efficiency. This is explained more fully under efficiency ratings.

The yearly rates of pay shown in the table on page 9 are based on 52 workweeks of 40 hours each, a total of 2,080 hours for the year. If an employee is required to work more than 40 hours in any week, he gets "overtime" pay for the extra hours of work. For employees who receive up to \$2,980 per year, this overtime pay is at a rate of $1\frac{1}{2}$ times the regular, or basic, hourly rate. The basic hourly rate may be found by dividing your annual salary rate by 2,080. Employees

Pay Scales under the Classification Act of 1923, as amended
[Effective July 11, 1948]

Service and grade				Salary steps within grade					Regular rates			Overtime
P	SP	CAF	CPC	Beginning		Middle		Top	Hourly	Per diem	Hourly	Hourly
1	1	1	1	\$1,410.00	\$1,500.00	\$1,588.00	\$1,660.00	\$1,732.00	\$0.6778846	\$5.4230769	\$1.0168269	
2	2	2	2	2,020.00	2,152.00	2,218.00	2,284.00	2,350.00	.9711538	7.7692307	1.4567307	
3	3	3	3	2,086.00	2,218.00	2,284.00	2,350.00	2,428.00	1.0028846	8.0230769	1.5043269	
4	4	4	4	2,152.00	2,284.00	2,350.00	2,428.00	2,498.00	1.0346153	8.2769230	1.5519230	
5	5	5	5	2,218.00	2,350.00	2,428.00	2,498.00	2,573.52	1.0680769	8.5307692	1.6016442	
6	6	6	6	2,284.00	2,428.00	2,498.00	2,573.52	2,648.76	1.1000000	8.7846153	1.6471153	
7	7	7	7	2,350.00	2,498.00	2,573.52	2,648.76	2,724.00	1.1298076	9.0384615	1.6947115	
8	8	8	8	2,428.00	2,573.52	2,648.76	2,724.00	2,799.24	1.1610576	9.2884615	1.7428382	
9	9	9	9	2,498.00	2,648.76	2,724.00	2,799.24	2,874.48	1.1923077	9.5384615	1.7912307	
10	10	10	10	2,573.52	2,724.00	2,799.24	2,874.48	2,949.72	1.2230769	9.7884615	1.8384615	
11	11	11	11	2,648.76	2,799.24	2,874.48	2,949.72	3,024.96	1.2530769	10.0384615	1.8846153	
12	12	12	12	2,724.00	2,874.48	2,949.72	3,024.96	3,100.20	1.2830769	10.2884615	1.9307692	
13	13	13	13	2,799.24	2,949.72	3,024.96	3,100.20	3,175.44	1.3130769	10.5384615	1.9769230	
14	14	14	14	2,874.48	3,024.96	3,100.20	3,175.44	3,250.68	1.3430769	10.7884615	2.0230769	
15	15	15	15	2,949.72	3,100.20	3,175.44	3,250.68	3,325.92	1.3730769	11.0384615	2.0692307	
16	16	16	16	3,024.96	3,175.44	3,250.68	3,325.92	3,401.16	1.4030769	11.2884615	2.1153846	
17	17	17	17	3,100.20	3,250.68	3,325.92	3,401.16	3,476.40	1.4330769	11.5384615	2.1615384	
18	18	18	18	3,175.44	3,325.92	3,401.16	3,476.40	3,551.68	1.4630769	11.7884615	2.2076923	
19	19	19	19	3,250.68	3,401.16	3,476.40	3,551.68	3,626.92	1.4930769	12.0384615	2.2538461	
20	20	20	20	3,325.92	3,476.40	3,551.68	3,626.92	3,702.16	1.5230769	12.2884615	2.3000000	
21	21	21	21	3,401.16	3,551.68	3,626.92	3,702.16	3,777.40	1.5530769	12.5384615	2.3461538	
22	22	22	22	3,476.40	3,626.92	3,702.16	3,777.40	3,852.64	1.5830769	12.7884615	2.3923077	
23	23	23	23	3,551.68	3,702.16	3,777.40	3,852.64	3,927.88	1.6130769	13.0384615	2.4384615	
24	24	24	24	3,626.92	3,777.40	3,852.64	3,927.88	4,003.12	1.6430769	13.2884615	2.4846153	
25	25	25	25	3,702.16	3,852.64	3,927.88	4,003.12	4,078.36	1.6730769	13.5384615	2.5307692	
26	26	26	26	3,777.40	3,927.88	4,003.12	4,078.36	4,153.60	1.7030769	13.7884615	2.5769230	
27	27	27	27	3,852.64	4,003.12	4,078.36	4,153.60	4,228.84	1.7330769	14.0384615	2.6230769	
28	28	28	28	3,927.88	4,078.36	4,153.60	4,228.84	4,304.08	1.7630769	14.2884615	2.6692307	
29	29	29	29	4,003.12	4,153.60	4,228.84	4,304.08	4,379.32	1.7930769	14.5384615	2.7153846	
30	30	30	30	4,078.36	4,228.84	4,304.08	4,379.32	4,454.56	1.8230769	14.7884615	2.7615384	
31	31	31	31	4,153.60	4,304.08	4,379.32	4,454.56	4,529.80	1.8530769	15.0384615	2.8076923	
32	32	32	32	4,228.84	4,379.32	4,454.56	4,529.80	4,605.04	1.8830769	15.2884615	2.8538461	
33	33	33	33	4,304.08	4,454.56	4,529.80	4,605.04	4,680.28	1.9130769	15.5384615	2.9000000	
34	34	34	34	4,379.32	4,529.80	4,605.04	4,680.28	4,755.52	1.9430769	15.7884615	2.9461538	
35	35	35	35	4,454.56	4,605.04	4,680.28	4,755.52	4,830.76	1.9730769	16.0384615	2.9923077	
36	36	36	36	4,529.80	4,680.28	4,755.52	4,830.76	4,906.00	2.0030769	16.2884615	3.0384615	
37	37	37	37	4,605.04	4,755.52	4,830.76	4,906.00	4,981.24	2.0330769	16.5384615	3.0846153	
38	38	38	38	4,680.28	4,830.76	4,906.00	4,981.24	5,056.48	2.0630769	16.7884615	3.1307692	
39	39	39	39	4,755.52	4,906.00	4,981.24	5,056.48	5,131.72	2.0930769	17.0384615	3.1769230	
40	40	40	40	4,830.76	4,981.24	5,056.48	5,131.72	5,206.96	2.1230769	17.2884615	3.2230769	
41	41	41	41	4,906.00	5,056.48	5,131.72	5,206.96	5,282.20	2.1530769	17.5384615	3.2692307	
42	42	42	42	4,981.24	5,131.72	5,206.96	5,282.20	5,357.44	2.1830769	17.7884615	3.3153846	
43	43	43	43	5,056.48	5,206.96	5,282.20	5,357.44	5,432.68	2.2130769	18.0384615	3.3615384	
44	44	44	44	5,131.72	5,282.20	5,357.44	5,432.68	5,507.92	2.2430769	18.2884615	3.4076923	
45	45	45	45	5,206.96	5,357.44	5,432.68	5,507.92	5,583.16	2.2730769	18.5384615	3.4538461	
46	46	46	46	5,282.20	5,432.68	5,507.92	5,583.16	5,658.40	2.3030769	18.7884615	3.5000000	
47	47	47	47	5,357.44	5,507.92	5,583.16	5,658.40	5,733.64	2.3330769	19.0384615	3.5461538	
48	48	48	48	5,432.68	5,583.16	5,658.40	5,733.64	5,808.88	2.3630769	19.2884615	3.5923077	
49	49	49	49	5,507.92	5,658.40	5,733.64	5,808.88	5,884.12	2.3930769	19.5384615	3.6384615	
50	50	50	50	5,583.16	5,733.64	5,808.88	5,884.12	5,959.36	2.4230769	19.7884615	3.6846153	
51	51	51	51	5,658.40	5,808.88	5,884.12	5,959.36	6,034.60	2.4530769	20.0384615	3.7307692	
52	52	52	52	5,733.64	5,884.12	5,959.36	6,034.60	6,109.84	2.4830769	20.2884615	3.7769230	
53	53	53	53	5,808.88	5,959.36	6,034.60	6,109.84	6,185.08	2.5130769	20.5384615	3.8230769	
54	54	54	54	5,884.12	6,034.60	6,109.84	6,185.08	6,260.32	2.5430769	20.7884615	3.8692307	
55	55	55	55	5,959.36	6,109.84	6,185.08	6,260.32	6,335.56	2.5730769	21.0384615	3.9153846	
56	56	56	56	6,034.60	6,185.08	6,260.32	6,335.56	6,410.80	2.6030769	21.2884615	3.9615384	
57	57	57	57	6,109.84	6,260.32	6,335.56	6,410.80	6,486.04	2.6330769	21.5384615	4.0076923	
58	58	58	58	6,185.08	6,335.56	6,410.80	6,486.04	6,561.28	2.6630769	21.7884615	4.0538461	
59	59	59	59	6,260.32	6,410.80	6,486.04	6,561.28	6,636.52	2.6930769	22.0384615	4.1000000	
60	60	60	60	6,335.56	6,486.04	6,561.28	6,636.52	6,711.76	2.7230769	22.2884615	4.1461538	
61	61	61	61	6,410.80	6,561.28	6,636.52	6,711.76	6,787.00	2.7530769	22.5384615	4.1923077	
62	62	62	62	6,486.04	6,636.52	6,711.76	6,787.00	6,862.24	2.7830769	22.7884615	4.2384615	
63	63	63	63	6,561.28	6,711.76	6,787.00	6,862.24	6,937.48	2.8130769	23.0384615	4.2846153	
64	64	64	64	6,636.52	6,787.00	6,862.24	6,937.48	7,012.72	2.8430769	23.2884615	4.3307692	
65	65	65	65	6,711.76	6,862.24	6,937.48	7,012.72	7,087.96	2.8730769	23.5384615	4.3769230	
66	66	66	66	6,787.00	6,937.48	7,012.72	7,087.96	7,163.20	2.9030769	23.7884615	4.4230769	
67	67	67	67	6,862.24	7,012.72	7,087.96	7,163.20	7,238.44	2.9330769	24.0384615	4.4692307	
68	68	68	68	6,937.48	7,087.96	7,163.20	7,238.44	7,313.68	2.9630769	24.2884615	4.5153846	
69	69	69	69	7,012.72	7,163.20	7,238.44	7,313.68	7,388.92	2.9930769	24.5384615	4.5615384	
70	70	70	70	7,087.96	7,238.44	7,313.68	7,388.92	7,464.16	3.0230769	24.7884615	4.6076923	
71	71	71	71	7,163.20	7,313.68	7,388.92	7,464.16	7,539.40	3.0530769	25.0384615	4.6538461	
72	72	72	72	7,238.44	7,388.92	7,464.16	7,539.40	7,614.64	3.0830769	25.2884615	4.7000000	
73	73	73	73	7,313.68	7,464.16	7,539.40	7,614.64	7,689.88	3.1130769	25.5384615	4.7461538	
74	74	74	74	7,388.92	7,539.40	7,614.64	7,689.88	7,765.12	3.1430769	25.7884615	4.7923077	
75	75	75	75	7,464.16	7,614.64	7,689.88	7,765.12	7,840.36	3.1730769	26.0384615	4.8384615	
76	76	76	76	7,539.40	7,689.88	7,765.12	7,840.36	7,915.60	3.2030769	26.2884615	4.8846153	
77	77	77	77	7,614.64	7,765.12	7,840.36	7,915.60	7,990.84	3.2330769	26.5384615	4.9307692	
78	78	78	78	7,689.88	7,840.36	7,915.60	7,990.84	8,066.08	3.2630769	26.7884615	4.9769230	
79	79	79	79	7,765.12	7,915.60	7,990.84	8,066.08	8,141.32	3.2930769	27.0384615	5.0230769	
80	80	80	80	7,840.36	7,990.84	8,066.08	8,141.32	8,216.56	3.3230769	27.2884615	5.0692307	
81	81	81	81	7,915.60	8,066.08	8,141.32	8,216.56	8,291.80	3.3530769	27.5384615	5.1153846	
82	82	82	82	7,990.84	8,141.32	8,216.56	8,291.80	8,367.04	3.3830769	27.7884615	5.1615384	
83	83	83	83	8,066.08	8,216.56	8,291.80	8,367.04	8,442.28	3.4130769			

who are required to work on a holiday are paid double their regular basic rate for such work.

Employees who work regularly at night (between 6 p. m. and 6 a. m.) get an extra 10 percent for such work. Employees who work in Alaska and other outlying Territories and possessions may get up to an additional 25 percent of their basic salaries to offset the extra costs of living. Those who work in foreign countries may get a "post differential" as well as allowances for quarters and extra costs of living.

Deductions.—Various deductions are taken from your pay. If you are under the Retirement Act, 6 percent of your basic pay is deducted and placed to your credit in the retirement fund. Income taxes are deducted from your salary each pay day. If you are buying Government bonds through the pay-roll deduction plan, the amount which you have authorized is taken from your salary each pay period for this purpose. Some field employees are supplied with living quarters, meals, or other items, which are charged against their salaries.

Some bureaus of the Department give each employee an itemized statement with each pay check which shows the amounts for basic pay, overtime, night differential, etc., that go to make up the gross salary. The statement also shows the amounts deducted for retirement, income tax, bonds, etc.

The positions of most laborers and skilled craftsmen who work for the Department are exempt from the Classification Act of 1923, as amended. These employees are not paid, therefore, at the rates shown in the pay scales in this Handbook. They are paid local prevailing wage rates. These rates are set by wage boards or by administrative action.

Budgeting.—Some employees have difficulty in meeting all their expenses. Others manage on their pay checks to keep out of debt but feel that on present incomes they should be able to live more comfortably than they do. A little planning or budgeting helps to make one's income go farther. Whatever form your budget takes, planned spending will give you more satisfaction for money spent. It will permit greater saving for future enjoyment, help you to avoid running into debt, and make possible better living by providing for necessities first, then comforts, then luxuries.

Your income tax.—Under the present income tax laws your Department withholds a portion of your salary each pay day, as current payment of income tax. These withholdings are paid to the Bureau of Internal Revenue for you and you may take credit for the amounts withheld on your income tax return for the year. On or before January 31 of each year the Department furnishes you and the Bureau of Internal Revenue with a statement showing your annual gross salary from the Department and the amount withheld for in-

come tax purposes. The statement which you receive may be used by you, under certain provisions of the law, as your income tax return or may aid you in computing your income tax on the longer income tax return forms.

In computing your income tax, use your gross salary (base pay plus night differentials, etc.) not your pay after deductions for retirement, bonds, etc., have been made. Many States (and the city of Philadelphia and District of Columbia) also levy income taxes, and the Department notifies these States and cities of your annual gross salary. You are responsible for learning about your local laws and complying with them.

Dual compensation.—There are laws which restrict the right of employees to receive pay from more than one position under the Federal Government when the combined salaries exceed certain amounts. These restrictions are modified for certain groups of employees, particularly retired enlisted men and officers of the armed forces of the United States. If you contemplate holding more than one Federal job or getting pay from more than one Federal source, check with your bureau personnel office before doing so to see if it is lawful.



LEAVE



THERE ARE THREE main types of leave with pay—annual leave, sick leave, and military leave.

Annual leave.—Permanent employees earn 1 day of leave each pay period. They earn 4 hours' leave for each half pay period. Annual leave is granted in units of 1 hour. It must be approved in advance by your supervisor. As the interest of the Department must be considered first, you may not always be

granted leave just when you want it. Be sure to plan well ahead of time when possible. If you have a permanent appointment, after you have been here continuously for a year and if you do not plan on leaving the service within the next 12 months, you make take in advance the leave you will earn during the 12 months' period.

You may also save your leave up to 60 days for carry-over into the next year. If you transfer to another Government agency under the same leave system, the leave to your credit is transferred with you.

Should you leave the Government service, or transfer from a permanent position to a temporary position, or vice versa, or if you transfer from the Department to a Government agency which is under a different leave system, you will then receive a lump-sum payment for all annual leave which you have earned but have not used. If you have used more annual leave than you have earned, deduction for the unearned leave will be made from your final pay check. If you die while in the service, payment for your annual leave is made to the beneficiary of your retirement fund. If you have not designated one, payment is made to your next of kin.

Temporary employees (those whose appointments are limited to 1 year or less) earn $2\frac{1}{2}$ days of annual leave for each month of service. A "service month" consists of 30 consecutive calendar days. A temporary employee may not take his leave until he has earned it. Leave for temporary employees may be transferred within the Department, but such leave may not be transferred to another Government agency.

Sick leave.—Whether you are a permanent or a temporary employee you earn $1\frac{1}{4}$ days of sick leave a month, and may accumulate

sick leave up to 90 days. Sick leave is charged in units of 1 hour. Sick leave may be granted for illness, injury, pregnancy, or confinement, or for medical, dental, or optical examination or treatment. It may also be granted when a member of your family is afflicted with a contagious disease and you are placed under quarantine by the health department, or when, through exposure to contagious disease, your presence might endanger the health of your fellow employees.

If you are unable to come to work because of illness, notify your supervisor as soon as possible on the first day of your absence. You can sign for your sick leave on your return. You must have the signature of a physician if you are absent for more than 3 days, unless the office accepts your personal certificate giving reasons why you didn't have a doctor. Sick leave for medical, dental, or optical treatment must be approved in advance. If you are sick while you are on annual leave, you may, at the discretion of the Department, convert annual leave into sick leave but you must have been ill for 5 continuous work days and have a doctor's certificate, unless the office accepts your personal certificate giving your reasons for not having a doctor. Be sure to give your supervisor a memorandum stating the circumstances within 2 days after your return.

Military leave.—Permanent and temporary indefinite employees who are members of the National Guard or of one of the reserve units of the Army or Navy may be granted 15 calendar days of military leave with pay each year for defense or training activities. When you receive orders for such duty, check with your supervisor for details.

Leave without pay.—Emergencies sometimes exhaust leave credits. Under certain circumstances, you may be granted leave without pay; be sure to talk with your supervisor well in advance if you see a real need ahead. Absence without permission may be cause for disciplinary action.

Court and jury leave.—Federal employees are occasionally called for court or jury duty. "Official leave" with pay is granted to permanent employees for jury duty and sometimes for court leave. In such cases, no charge against annual leave is made. If you are summoned, check with your supervisor at once.

YOUR CAREER

Appointment.—Up to March 16, 1942, most of the employees in the Department were appointed from Civil Service registers. On March 16, 1942, the war-service regulations were put into effect, and war-service appointments were made for the duration and 6 months thereafter.

On March 6, 1946, "interim" regulations were issued preparatory to a return to permanent civil service procedures. Under these regulations new employees had to come in on temporary appointments "pending establishment" of civil service registers. If you are serving under a war-service appointment or one of these "temporary" appointments and pass one of the examinations which the Commission is now holding, your name will be placed on a register. When your name is reached, you will become eligible to be considered for a probational appointment.

On May 1, 1948, the Civil Service Commission issued revised Civil Service Rules and Regulations which provide for a return to permanent civil service procedures whereby appointees will be selected from registers of eligibles as a result of competitive examinations and will be given probationary appointments. When you are given a probational appointment, you must serve what is known as a probationary period to prove that you are fit and capable of doing your job. This period is 1 year. During this time, you may be dismissed for inefficiency, misconduct, etc., without much formality. After this period is over, before you can be dropped for these reasons, you must be given notification in writing of the reasons for the proposed dismissal, and you have the right to appeal the action.

Transfers.—Sometimes you may feel as if you would like to change your job. The Department has offices in all of the different States. If you want to transfer to another location, either in a different bureau, or to some other place in your own bureau, talk to your supervisor or personnel officer about it.

It is your responsibility to give honest and efficient service to the Department. Likewise, it is the responsibility of the Department to make the best possible use of your services. Therefore, it may become necessary for you to be transferred from one division or unit, or from one headquarters to another. Such transfers should broaden your experience and promote advancement.



Opportunity for advancement.—It is the policy of the Department to use the skill, qualifications, and experience of each employee to the fullest, by placing him in the position for which he is best fitted and in which he will be satisfied and will give his best performance. [The personnel policy of the Department is stated in appendix II.]

It is the general Department policy to fill vacancies in the higher grades by promoting present employees. For instance, when a CAF-4 job is to be filled, we try to find a replacement among the CAF-3's. When it is known that there is such a vacancy, the bureaus will review the qualifications of employees who are eligible for consideration. If a qualified employee is located, he will be selected for promotion. In considering employees who are qualified and eligible for promotion, reassignment, and transfer, the policy will be to consider first those within the immediate part of the bureau in which the vacancy occurs, next those within the division or region, then those within the bureau as a whole, and finally those within the Department itself.

In some cases your supervisor may decide your work involves more responsibility or difficulty than originally planned and that the job itself should be classified higher than it is. He will then consult his bureau personnel officer, and a new job description which more nearly describes your duties will be written up. If it is approved by the Department and you are continued in the reclassified job, your grade and pay will go up to the new level.

Training.—Promotion is usually the result of increase of skill on the job and capacity to get along with people. Efficiency is a first requirement. Your supervisor is responsible for your training, but the learning is your job. To save the supervisor's time, try to think out carefully the questions you need to have answered and ask them at the first opportunity. Work done wrong wastes everybody's time. Find out all you can about the work of your division. The Department needs versatile, alert help, ready to adapt itself to new responsibilities and situations.

To keep us informed on what the Department as a whole is doing and why, many bureaus occasionally have orientation programs at which speakers discuss current problems and achievements. The Department news bulletin USDA, which comes out twice a month, includes stories on important policy developments, along with other material especially valuable for orientation. USDA helps us answer the questions asked by family and friends and explains much of our own work.

Refresher courses in shorthand and office skills are organized from

time to time in most offices. Let your supervisor know if you are interested, so that you can be included in the next class.

Veteran provisions.—The Department has been approved by the Veterans' Administration for special on-the-job training for veterans, under Public Laws 346 and 16. Bureaus, in turn, may be certified by the Secretary of Agriculture and approved by the Veterans' Administration.

Eligible veterans may receive this on-the-job training when it is desired to prepare them quickly or to intensify their training for greater responsibilities and when there is a good chance of promotion at the end of the training period. In most cases, the training period is 1 year. *Your supervisor is familiar with the details of the veteran training program; he will know whether or not you are eligible.*

After-hour courses in local schools and extension or correspondence courses are other opportunities offered to veterans and provided for under Public Laws 346 and 16. Also, leaves of absence may be planned for full-time study.

Educational counseling.—Many employees have latent abilities that could be developed to the mutual benefit of the Department and the employee. It is your responsibility to develop your abilities to the maximum so as to render the most efficient public service. It is the policy of the Department to give you an opportunity to fit yourself for the job ahead and to develop an understudy to take your place. You should develop a plan, written or mental, that sets up your career objectives. Your reading, education, training, experience, and other essential means of development can then be directed toward your objective. Your supervisor can assist you in preparing this career-service plan. Counseling on your needs for formal education and means of obtaining it can be provided by your supervisor. If additional counseling is needed he can refer you to a specialist who is qualified to advise you.

The USDA Graduate School.—The Graduate School provides you with opportunities to train for proficiency in your present position, for advancement to a better position, and for advancement educationally as you progress in job proficiency and responsibility. Organized, formal educational programs in the Graduate School center in Washington, where you are provided with opportunities for graduate and undergraduate work. The educational needs of field employees usually are met by enlisting the cooperation of local institutions. In some cases, however, such needs are met through short courses or institutes for groups of employees. Correspondence study aids Agriculture employees in isolated areas or in subjects not otherwise covered.

Since its organization in 1921 the facilities of the Graduate School have been available to all qualified Federal employees and to others insofar as facilities permit. Washington classes meet after hours in

Department and other Government buildings. The faculty is drawn almost entirely from the Federal service, a source of talent and expertness unexcelled anywhere in the Nation.

The resident curricula consist chiefly of courses in the biological, physical, and social sciences, in languages and literature, in mathematics and statistics, in public administration, in Federal clerical and administrative techniques, and in the mechanical arts. Seminars or lecture series with discussion facilities are provided for advanced graduate students and for the higher scientific and administrative officials. Other courses in the arts and sciences provide you with broad opportunities for continuation study along the lines of your general interest as an individual as well as your special interests as an employee. The curriculum is planned to enable you to continue your work toward an undergraduate and graduate degree.

Careful planning of your educational program is important if you are a prospective student. It is particularly important if you are a Department employee in Washington and wish to make a substantial beginning in the Graduate School, where degrees are not granted and credits must eventually be transferred to a degree-conferring institution. It is important that you set up a program which includes a group of logically related courses in a special field of study. Officers of the Graduate School are available to give you counsel on educational plans, whether to be pursued in the Graduate School or in other institutions.

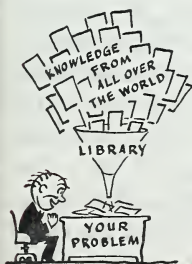
Graduate School courses, both residence and correspondence, are available to veterans of World War II under the provisions of Public Laws 346 and 16. Registration for part-time study is charged against educational benefits only in the proportion that the number of semester hours bears to a full normal load.

For catalog and other information, write to the Graduate School, United States Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C., or call at the office, room 1031, South Building.

The library.—The Department of Agriculture Library is an important tool in the research and administration work of the Department. It has the greatest collection of agricultural publications in the world and includes materials helpful in the performance of practically every job in the Department.

In addition to ordinary library service, such as routing current periodicals, lending books, and answering questions, the library compiles bibliographies and prepares literature surveys to bring all the world's knowledge to bear on the solution of the problem at hand. The monthly Bibliography of Agriculture enables all workers in the field of agriculture to keep abreast of new developments.

Everyone in the Department is welcome to use



the library. Services may be obtained by visiting, writing, or telephoning to either the main library in Washington or one of the branch libraries. Each Regional Research Laboratory has a branch library. In addition, there are 12 branch libraries in the field. For information regarding location of these branch libraries see your supervisor.



Efficiency ratings.—Federal Government employees are given an efficiency rating when they are appointed or when they change their jobs, 6 months after going on the new or changed job, and annually thereafter. The new employee is presumed to deserve a rating of “good”; thereafter his efficiency rating is largely what he himself makes it. This efficiency rating serves several purposes. It is a major factor considered in making pay raises, pay cuts, promotions, and dismissals. It tends to keep us on our toes. And it affords an excellent opportunity to discuss with your supervisor the requirements of your job and to receive suggestions for improving your work.

The efficiency rating is an evaluation of your work compared with the requirements of your job. If you study the rating form in this book, you will see on it a number of “job elements” by which performance can be measured. Not all the elements apply to every job, of course, and we are evaluated on only those that apply to us. Farmers Home Administration and certain other agencies substitute elements that apply to the specific job to which the employee is assigned rather than using the 31 elements listed on SF-51.

The initial rating is made by your supervisor, who is thoroughly familiar with your work; it is then checked by his supervisor, who is also familiar with your work. This rating, which may be “excellent,” “very good,” “good,” “fair,” or “unsatisfactory,” is then reviewed by a bureau or regional efficiency rating committee. The committee may approve the rating as submitted or change it after consultation with the supervisors. The rating approved by the committee then becomes your “official” rating. This standardized and objective system is used to insure that, insofar as humanly possible, every rating shall be accurate and that the same standards for rating shall be used in every part of every agency of the Government.

Soon after the committee has reviewed and approved your rating, you are given a written notice informing you what it is. If you consider yours unfair, you may appeal within 15 days to the efficiency-rating committee in your bureau or office, and, if you are dissatisfied with its decision, you may direct your appeal to the Chairman of the Department of Agriculture Board of Review on Efficiency Ratings, United States Civil Service Commission, Washington, D. C. You may do so within 30 days after receipt of your rating. (Refer to current Efficiency Rating Manual for Department and Field Service.)

The efficiency rating you earn makes a great deal of difference to

you. People with the better efficiency ratings—not people with poor ratings—are considered for promotion when vacancies occur. Your rating also affects your pay. At specified intervals (1 year if lower than CAF-11 or P-4, and 18 months if CAF-11, P-4 or higher), employees with ratings of “good” or better are eligible for a raise to the “next step” in their grades. On the other hand, employees with “fair” ratings are not eligible for a raise and will be reduced one step

Standard Form No. 51
August 1946
U. S. CIVIL SERVICE COMMISSION

Form approved
Budget Bureau No. 50-R012.2

REPORT OF EFFICIENCY RATING

ADMINISTRATIVE-UNOFFICIAL ()
OFFICIAL:
REGULAR (✓)

As of March 31, 1948 based on performance during period from April 1, 1947 to March 31, 1948

Mary Lou Smith

Clerk-Typist, CAF-3

(Name of employee)

(Title of position, service, and grade)

Office of Personnel, Division of Employment, Records Section

(Organization—Indicate bureau, division, section, unit, field station)

ON LINES BELOW MARK EMPLOYEE	1. Study the instructions in the Rating Official's Guide, C. S. C. Form No. 3823A. 2. Underline the elements which are especially important in the position. 3. Rate only on elements pertinent to the position. a. Do not rate on elements in <i>italics</i> except for employees in administrative, supervisory, or planning positions. b. Rate administrative, supervisory, and planning functions on elements in <i>italics</i> .	CHECK ONE: Administrative, supervisory, or planning ☐ All others..... ☒
✓ if adequate - if weak + if outstanding		

- ____ (1) Maintenance of equipment, tools, instruments.
- ✓ (2) Mechanical skill.
- ✓ (3) Skill in the application of techniques and procedures.
- + (4) Presentability of work (appropriateness of arrangement and appearance of work).
- ____ (5) Attention to broad phases of assignments.
- + (6) Attention to pertinent detail.
- + (7) Accuracy of operations.
- ____ (8) Accuracy of final results.
- ____ (9) Accuracy of judgments or decisions.
- ____ (10) Effectiveness in presenting ideas or facts.
- ✓ (11) Industry.
- ____ (12) Rate of progress on or completion of assignments.
- ✓ (13) Amount of acceptable work produced. (Is mark based on production records?) (Yes or no) Yes
- ____ (14) Ability to organize his work.
- ____ (15) Effectiveness in meeting and dealing with others.
- + (16) Cooperativeness.
- ____ (17) Initiative.
- ____ (18) Resourcefulness.
- ✓ (19) Dependability.
- ____ (20) Physical fitness for the work.

- ____ (21) Effectiveness in planning broad programs.
- ____ (22) Effectiveness in adapting the work program to broader or related programs.
- ____ (23) Effectiveness in devising procedures.
- ____ (24) Effectiveness in laying out work and establishing standards of performance for subordinates.
- ____ (25) Effectiveness in directing, reviewing, and checking the work of subordinates.
- ____ (26) Effectiveness in instructing, training, and developing subordinates in the work.
- ____ (27) Effectiveness in promoting high working morale.
- ____ (28) Effectiveness in determining space, personnel, and equipment needs.
- ____ (29) Effectiveness in getting and obtaining adherence to time limits and deadlines.
- ____ (30) Ability to make decisions.
- ____ (31) Effectiveness in delegating clearly defined authority to act.

STATE ANY OTHER ELEMENTS CONSIDERED

- ____ (A) _____
- ____ (B) _____
- ____ (C) _____

STANDARD Deviations must be explained on reverse side of this form		Adjective Rating
Plus marks on all underlined elements, and check marks or better on all other elements rated.....	Excellent	Rating official..... <u>VG</u>
Check marks or better on all elements rated, and plus marks on at least half of the underlined elements.....	Very Good	
Check marks or better on a majority of underlined elements, and all weak performance overcompensated by outstanding performance.....	Good	Reviewing official..... <u>VG</u>
Check marks or better on a majority of underlined elements, and all weak performance not overcompensated by outstanding performance.....	Fair	
Minus marks on at least half of the underlined elements.....	Unsatisfactory	
Rated by <u>John L. Jones</u> Head, Records Section April 1, 1948 (Signature of rating official) (Title) (Date) Reviewed by <u>Robert Brown</u> Chief, Employment Div. April 2, 1948 (Signature of reviewing official) (Title) (Date) Rating approved by efficiency rating committee <u>May 3, 1948</u> Report to employee <u>VG</u> (Date) (Adjective Rating)		

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if they are already above the middle step in the grade. Employees with "unsatisfactory" ratings may be demoted or dismissed from the service or they may be assigned new and different duties.

You can derive the greatest value from the efficiency rating program if you discuss your work performance periodically with your supervisor. Supervisors welcome questions and are glad to give constructive suggestions.

Periodic pay increases.—Advancement in salary may come through periodic pay increases within the salary range for your grade. These increases are effective on the first day of the pay period following the date upon which you meet the requirements for the increase. Here is an example of how an employee may get such a raise: On August 14, 1948, Mary Smith was hired as a CAF-3 clerk. The following June her efficiency was rated as "good." On August 13, 1949, she had completed her 12 months of service. Her supervisor certified that her conduct and service had been satisfactory. She had now become eligible for a periodic pay increase from \$2,498.28 to \$2,573.52 per year. However, since such raises are made only at the beginning of pay periods, her raise in pay actually started on August 22, 1949.

There is another one-step pay increase during each 12 or 18 months' period for which employees may become eligible. This is one for "superior accomplishment" and is given to those who make contributions of outstanding value to the Department.

Grievances.—If for any reason you feel you are not being treated fairly or if you have other serious complaints, you should think through your problem and talk it over frankly with your supervisor and others concerned. They should understand your point of view and you understand theirs—mutual understanding of problems frequently clears them up.



If you wish, you may also review your problem with your personnel officer. He has had experience with other problems of a similar nature, and his experience will usually be a big help in obtaining a satisfactory solution. If it should become necessary to present your problem to the Department Office of Personnel, your fair employment officer, and the Secretary, the Personnel Relations Appeals Procedure as

well as the Memorandum on Fair Employment Practices in appendix II will tell you how to go about it.

Reduction in force.—From time to time the Department has to reduce the number of its employees. Sometimes we have budget cuts which result in positions being abolished. There are times when the work of a unit changes and employees have to be dropped because their duties are no longer a part of the agency's program. Personnel

"ceilings" set by the Bureau of the Budget are another cause. No matter how ample the agency's appropriation is, it must reduce its force, if the "ceiling" calls for a smaller number of employees.

In a reduction in force, the first group to go would be the temporary employees; next would go war-service people and those appointed since March 6, 1946, pending the setting-up of civil-service registers; then probationary employees. Last to go would be permanent employees. Within each of these groups, the order of separation is governed by veteran preference, efficiency ratings, and years of service.

Employees reached for reduction in force have certain rights to be assigned to other positions in the Department for which they qualify. The positions may be either vacancies or positions occupied by other employees who are in a lower category for retention. The extent of the right is determined by tenure of appointment, civil-service status, veteran preference, efficiency, and years of service.

Some reductions in force which involve only budget cuts may result in grade demotions instead of separations. The agencies may make enough demotions to offset the cut in funds.

If an employee is to be separated from the service, he will get at least a 30-day notice, either as an active worker, or on accrued annual leave, leave without pay, or furlough without pay pending separation. Permanent employees with civil-service status and at least a "Good" efficiency rating are given 1-year notices of separation unless fiscal conditions prevent it. During most of this notice period, the employee is carried in a furlough-without-pay status.

An employee has the right of appeal to the Civil Service Commission if he thinks his separation is unfair. He can also examine the separation list to see how separations were made.

Retirement.—In 1920 Congress passed the Civil Service Retirement Act, providing a retirement system for Government employees. This law, with later changes, gives retirement coverage to practically all full-time Government workers except those with temporary appointments of 1 year or less.

Your retirement benefit is jointly paid by you and the Government. Each pay day your pay-roll office deducts 6 percent from your basic salary. This is your share. As long as you are on the pay roll, or on furlough, the deductions made from your salary will earn 3 percent interest. When you retire you receive an annuity paid in monthly installments. The Government contributes toward this annuity at least as much as you do, and, in most cases, more.



If you leave before you have worked 5 years, you have no right to a

future annuity and your deductions will be refunded to you upon application.

If you remain in the service for 5 years or more, you will be entitled to a future annuity at 62. This is true even if you leave the service before you reach that age. It is also true if you are removed on charges involving misconduct or delinquency. Your deductions draw interest at the rate of 3 percent from the date of separation to the date that your annuity begins.

If you leave the service with less than 20 years of civilian service you may receive a refund of all deductions, plus interest. No interest is paid on service of less than 1 year. However, unless the amount of this refund is redeposited before you retire, the service covered by the refund cannot be counted in determining the amount of your annuity.

Retirement is automatic at the age of 70 years after 15 years of service unless an exception is made because of special needs for your qualifications. You may voluntarily retire at the age of 62 years after 15 years of service or at the age of 60 years after 30 years of service. It is possible for you to retire at the age of 55 after 30 years of service, but in so doing you sacrifice a part of your annuity. When you retire at 55 after 30 years of service, your annuity is reduced by 3 percent for each full year you are under 60.

Two formulas are used in computing annuities. For an employee whose average salary for the five highest consecutive years is less than \$5,000, the formula is 1 percent of the average salary plus \$25, multiplied by the years of service. For an employee whose average salary is \$5,000, or more, the formula is $1\frac{1}{2}$ percent of the average salary multiplied by the years of service.

After 5 years of Federal service, no matter how old you are, you are eligible to receive an annuity for disability retirement if you have an accident or illness which leaves you too disabled to do your work. This disability may occur either on or off the job. You must prove that the disability is not caused by bad habits or willful misconduct on your part during the 5 years before you become disabled. You must have an annual medical examination until you are 60, unless the disability is one from which the doctors think that you will never recover sufficiently to come back to work.

If you want to increase the amount in your retirement fund, you may make voluntary contributions in multiples of \$25, which will increase your annuity. These contributions draw interest at the rate of 3 percent compounded annually. When you are separated from the service, or if you transfer to a position outside of the retirement system, you may withdraw the voluntary contributions.

If you die in the service, your widow and children will receive immediate annuities. The widow's annuity is equal to one-half of the

annuity due you at the time of your death, and each child will receive the least of the following amounts:

1. One-fourth of the annuity due you at your death, or
2. \$900, divided by the number of children, or
3. \$360.

The widow's annuity will continue until she dies or remarries. The children's annuities stop when they reach 18, marry, or die. If you are survived by your widow only, her annuity will begin when she is 50 years of age.

You should designate a beneficiary on Form 2806-1 to receive the sum to your credit in the retirement fund, if there is no survivor annuity—or, if there is such an annuity, the balance of your deductions, not used in paying your annuity and your survivor's annuity. You may secure more detailed information on retirement from your personnel office.

Last, but by no means least, plan for your retirement. What you do after that milestone is reached is largely being determined by the interests you are developing now.

Resignations.—If it becomes necessary for you to resign, you should submit your resignation to your supervisor. The resignation blank is on the reverse side of Standard Form 52. Your personnel office will have a supply of these. Read the pertinent parts of the leave, reinstatement, and retirement regulations if you are thinking about resigning. Please give your bureau enough notice to permit finding someone to take your place.

CONDUCT AS AN EMPLOYEE

Here are a few friendly words of caution as to your personal and official conduct as a member of the Department. You should keep in mind that since you are in the public service, you must give complete and sincere value in return for your salary, but more than that, you must also avoid conduct that might cause embarrassment to or criticism of the Department or interfere with the efficient performance of your duties.

Certain limitations are placed upon all Government employees by acts of Congress, and in some instances the laws provide that persons who violate them must be dismissed from the service. The law requires dismissal of an employee who:

Engages in prohibited political activity. See Department Administrative Regulations, title 8, chapter 57, for a full discussion of prohibited and permissible political activity.

Belongs to a political party or organization which advocates the overthrow of our constitutional form of government in the United States.

Solicits contributions for, or makes donations for, a gift for an official superior, or accepts a gift from subordinate employees.

Uses funds appropriated by Congress to influence a member of Congress to favor or oppose legislation.

Asks, accepts, or receives a bribe.

Conceals, removes, mutilates, or destroys Government records.

Expend funds or incurs obligations in excess of appropriations or authorizations.

There are other laws relating to the conduct of officials and employees of the Department which do not specify removal as a penalty, although violation of many of them constitutes a criminal offense. For example, drastic penalties are provided for knowingly making or presenting a false, fictitious, or fraudulent claim; entering into an agreement or conspiracy to defraud the Government by obtaining or aiding to obtain the payment or allowance of a false or fraudulent claim; knowingly and willfully falsifying or concealing a material fact by any trick, scheme, or device.

Employees also are prohibited by law from using, or authorizing the use of, Government vehicles for other than official purposes. The law prescribes a minimum penalty for violation of 1 month's suspension from duty without pay.

Business relations.—The Administrative Regulations of the Department, title 8, chapter 55, contain rules governing the personal conduct of employees. For example, employees who enforce regulations or who participate in the awarding of contracts are forbidden to accept entertainment, favors, or gifts of any sort from those with whom they have official relations. No employee may use his position, or information acquired through it, to advance the interests of himself, his family, his business associates, or his friends over those of other persons. Employees are forbidden to participate in the organization or management of any general farm organization. Employees may not borrow money from subordinates, or have a subordinate act as endorser or comaker of a note given as security for a personal loan.

Endorsement of commercial products.—Information developed by the Department is available to everyone, but naturally the Department wishes to guard against the misuse of such information. All employees should exercise caution in making statements that may be used in promoting commercial products or enterprises, including those tested or tried out in laboratory or field tests. There is no objection to giving the facts or to supplying illustrations upon request, but this must be done with the strict understanding that no effort will be made by the company to show in advertising or otherwise, either directly or by implication, that the Department endorses the product in question. Employees shall not allow the use of their names as endorsers of commercial products.

After-hour activities.—No employee should engage in outside work which decreases his efficiency for his official duties or is likely to cause embarrassment to the Department. If you have regular outside employment, tell your supervisor about it—this will help to prevent misunderstanding. It is the policy of the Department not to interfere with spare-time activities, but employees must realize that the Department is as easily embarrassed as any other business by excessive use of intoxicating liquor or other misconduct, by indebtedness, and other irregularities. Eventually such habits may lead to dismissal. New employees should bear in mind that their first year of employment is considered a probationary period.

Public contacts.—Remember that there is a strong tendency for citizens to judge the entire Department by your conduct toward them. This is especially true in the field, where any subordinate employee may thus mirror the Department to a visitor. But it is true in Washington, also. So, before you answer a letter, a telephone query, or a questioning visitor in person, stop and think what the Department would like you to say or do and how it would like you to speak or act. For you are not merely an individual—you represent the Department of Agriculture.

Your business reputation.—Although the credit affairs of employees are fundamentally their own concern, the Department expects all of its employees to conduct their financial affairs in an ethical manner and to keep their financial obligations. Irresponsibility on the part of a few employees may bring discredit upon the whole Department. Should business firms write to the Department about the delinquency of employees in settling their accounts, the Department will investigate and if the complaint is found to be a just one, the Department will notify the employee to make a satisfactory settlement. If this is not done, it may be necessary for the Director of Personnel to take disciplinary action. This complaint and a report from the employee concerned are made a part of the employee's official record.

SAFETY AND HEALTH



Safety.—Your safety and health are of major importance to the Department. No one can do his best work when not in tip-top physical condition. Safety engineers inspect working conditions in many offices and operations, and eliminate or minimize accident and fire hazards; however, many hazards can-

not be eliminated and new ones develop from time to time. The Department expects us to avoid accidents and report all hazards to our supervisors. You have a responsibility, however, to be on the alert for accident hazards and to cooperate with the safety officers. Even in office work many hazards are encountered, such as trailing electric and telephone cords, torn places in rugs, top-heavy filing cabinets and worn stair treads. If you work in a hazardous operation, be sure you know the safety regulations—ask your supervisor.

Your bureau representative in the Department Safety Council, which is composed of safety officers from each agency, will be glad to furnish you with copies of safety regulations, bulletins, and other safety literature. If you have had previous experience in accident- or fire-prevention work, you should notify your immediate superior and the safety officer. Trained safety workers can be useful in any organization.

First aid.—Emergency treatment of injuries is available to most Department employees. In some of the larger offices, emergency rooms are maintained to care for illnesses and injuries that occur during the day. You can note the location of the first-aid or emergency room on your office schedules. Field offices are equipped with first-aid kits, and usually there is someone in the office trained to use them. If you become ill while performing your official duties, either notify, or have someone notify your supervisor before going on sick leave. If injured during working hours, report to your supervisor in writing and go for treatment at once. This holds for minor injuries—cut fingers and bruises, as well as more serious accidents. If complications arise, this record will help to establish a claim for disability compensation or for treatment at the expense of the Bureau of Employees' Compensation.

Medical and hospital care for occupational injuries.—If you should need further care as the result of work-connected injury or

illness, your supervisor will send you to an approved physician or hospital. The Government pays for medical service and also allows compensation on duty-connected injuries, but it expects us to use Government-authorized facilities. Only in the most serious emergencies will private physicians be paid for first-aid treatment, and, in such cases, subsequent treatment must be given by a Public Health or designated doctor. To receive consideration, the bill for a private physician must be supported by a statement from the supervisor and must then be forwarded to the United States Bureau of Employees' Compensation, which reviews it before allowing payment.

Public Law 658, Seventy-ninth Congress, enabled Government departments and agencies to establish health services for Federal employees in localities where there is a sufficient number of employees to justify this service. The employee health programs are to be established after consultation with the United States Public Health Service. The enabling legislation limits such services to:

1. Treatment of on-the-job illnesses and dental conditions requiring emergency attention.
2. Preemployment and other physical examinations.
3. Referral of employees to private physicians and dentists.
4. Preventive programs relating to health.

The Division of Employee Health was recently established in Washington to carry out the provisions of this legislation. Two physicians are now employed in this Division, one of whom is stationed at the emergency rooms in the South Building.

Plans are being made, based upon surveys by the United States Public Health Service, to extend this service to as many field employees as possible.

A pilot program of this type is in operation at the Federal Center, Denver, Col. In this program, the participating governmental agencies have entered into a cooperative agreement and contracted with the United States Public Health Service to furnish the services. Information gained from this pilot program will be used in developing similar field programs elsewhere.

Chest X-rays.—Mass X-ray surveys are frequently made by the United States Public Health Service and by local and State departments of public health. All Department employees are urged to participate in these surveys as a means of protecting their own health and improving the general health of the community.

In locations where the facilities are available, the employees of the Department are also eligible for free chest X-ray examinations by the United States Public Health Service upon request. In Washington, employees may contact the supervising nurse in the emergency room. In field locations where no nurse or medical officer is employed, the employees should contact their supervisor or personnel officer.

The Division of Employee Health will aid the employees in the

interpretation of the X-ray reports and help in follow-up work to make this service effective.

Disability compensation.—Compensation for duty-connected injuries or illness includes free medical, surgical, and hospital treatment. Compensation payments may replace sick or annual leave with pay at any time after the third day; however, an employee having accrued leave will usually prefer to take it instead of receiving disability compensation, as salary received while on leave is higher than compensation benefits. Compensation payments for total disability are two-thirds of your salary, with a maximum benefit of \$116.66 a month. The minimum benefit is \$58.33 a month. Benefits for partial disability are fixed by the Bureau of Employees' Compensation and are paid as long as the disability continues or until you become eligible for disability retirement. For what to do "When Accidents Strike" see appendix II.

There are also provisions in case of death occurring in connection with duty, such as funeral expenses and benefit payments to children and dependents. To get compensation the Bureau of Employees' Compensation Form CA-1 must be submitted, within 48 hours after the injury if possible. Those who travel for the Department should have the list of Medical Facilities Available to Employees of United States Government. Ask your agency personnel office for it.

General care and insurance.—In most centers where there are large numbers of Federal employees, special cooperative health services and group hospitalization plans have been developed. You are urged to avail yourself of these plans in order to prevent as well as protect yourself against sudden illness or hospitalization which may come at a time when you are not financially able to provide complete care.

Insurance companies, both indemnity and life, frequently offer special policies to Federal employees. Specific information regarding these companies may be had by writing the superintendent of insurance of the State in which you are located.

The Department of Agriculture Beneficial Association.—This is a mutual nonprofit organization operated by and in the interest of the personnel. The primary purpose of the association is to provide life insurance for its members at low cost. Life insurance up to \$3,000, varying with the age of the applicant, is available. Physical examinations are not usually required. Claims are paid promptly. The association also has sickness, accident, and hospital insurance plans.

Employees interested in the association may write to Secretary-Treasurer, room 2944, South Building, Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C. Your supervisor or personnel officer will supply details if you wish to know more about any of these facilities.

BUILDING A BETTER DEPARTMENT



Management Improvement and Manpower Utilization Program.—The Department of Agriculture has earned over the years a reputation for economy and efficiency in its management; and the in-

dividual agencies of the Department have pursued as a matter of course a policy of periodically reexamining their organization, procedures, and operating methods to improve them. The need for a better coordination of these improvement efforts came during World War II, and, to answer this need, the Management Improvement and Manpower Utilization Program was established. The accomplishments during that challenging period of manpower and material shortages present a record of which we should all be proud. The coordination of these efforts to improve administration within the agencies needs to be continued if the Department is to render the most effective public service. New challenging problems confront us that will tax our ingenuity to improve management, conserve materials and equipment, and to use profitably each man-hour of employee time.

The objectives of our MIMU program are to save manpower, simplify procedures, save materials, speed operations, improve organization, and reduce costs.

There is a key management representative for each agency, bureau, and branch. Your key management representative: develops a plan of action for your agency; organizes to carry out the plan; devises systems and procedures for the program; provides for training employees in methods of analyzing and improving their work; publicizes the program; serves as chairman of the agency suggestion-awards committee; records accomplishments.

You can help in this program. How? The employees' suggestion system is a part of the over-all Management Improvement and Manpower Utilization Program, so one way you can help—and right now—is by making suggestions.

For a finer public service—Suggest work improvements.

Who wants your suggestions?

The Congress—Passed Public Law 600 (79th Cong.).

The President—Issued Executive Order 9817.

The Secretary—Approved Administrative Regulation 1AR650.

Your Key Management Representative—Serves as Chairman, Agency Suggestion Awards Committee.

The Public—Wants the best service for its tax dollar (you are a taxpayer too).

Cash awards.—A suggestion may bring you a cash award, a within-grade pay increase for superior accomplishment, or an honor award. Since the within-grade pay increase for superior accomplishment and honor awards are two of the Department's major incentive programs we will have more to say about them later. Use Form AD-287 for submitting your suggestion. Read the instructions on the back of the form. Don't forget that a suggestion often goes a long way. Prepare it carefully and develop it as well as you can. Send your suggestion to your supervisor or to the person designated by your agency or bureau.

Don't let good ideas get away from you. Write them down. Send them in.

Rewards for superior accomplishment.—Rewards in the form of an increase of one salary step within the salary range of the grade of the employee are given for outstanding performance. This special pay increase for outstanding performance may be the result of a new idea, or method for doing some phase of work, or of the excellent quantity and quality of work, or of an unusual act or service in the public interest.

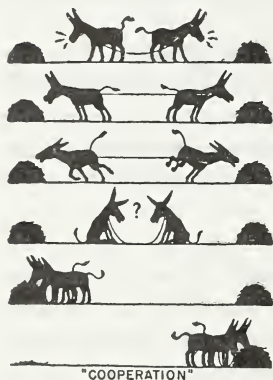
Honor awards.—The Department's annual recognition of exceptional employees through honor awards finds its legal authority in Public Law 600, Seventy-ninth Congress. It gives public recognition by appropriate ceremonies and suitable awards to those individuals who through their achievements and work have rendered outstanding service to the public.

The Department's program includes various types of awards, the highest of which is the distinguished service award, given for achievements of very broad or national significance. The recipient is given a gold medal, together with a certificate citing the achievement. The next highest form of recognition is the superior service award, given for achievements, the scope of which is not as broad as those warranting the distinguished service award. Recipients in this case receive a silver medal and certificate similar to those given for the distinguished service award. It is worthy of note that employees of all grades are eligible for both distinguished and superior service awards. The records indicate that a rather large percentage of employees in the lower grades have received superior service awards. The third form

of recognition in our honor awards program is the length-of-service certificate given for each 10 years of service with the Department. Accompanying the certificate is a pin or lapel button having a colored enamel band indicating the 10-year interval of service.

Organizational units or groups of employees working as a team are eligible for distinguished or superior service awards which are designated as unit awards. Such an award was given to the Zoological Division of the Bureau of Animal Industry for the discovery and development of phenothiazine, a drug of world-wide application and usefulness for the removal of internal parasites of domestic animals. The unit awards include a medal and certificate and are otherwise similar to the individual awards, with the exception that the ceremonies for making the awards are held, not in Washington, but at the headquarters of the unit receiving the award.

Individual distinguished and superior service awards are presented in Washington, D. C., on May 15 each year at the Sylvan Theater on the Washington Monument grounds. The ceremonies include music by one of the service bands, Army, Navy, or Marine, and the awards are presented by the Secretary of Agriculture. Individuals in the Washington area having 40 or more years of service receive their length-of-service certificates at the same ceremony. Following May 15 of each year, length-of-service and unit awards ceremonies are held by the various bureaus and agencies in Agriculture throughout the country.



Cooperation.—We can do a great deal to maintain harmony among the people in our office by being considerate of our fellow employees' feelings and by being polite but businesslike in our dealing with other units in our organization.

Your "boss."—Stop to consider just who your real employer—the public—is. Our "boss" is dairyman, poultryman, truck gardener, grain grower, cattle raiser, hunter, fisherman, sightseer, tobacco and cotton planter, timberman, and specialist in many other fields. He is owner, share cropper, renter, business farmer, and subsistence

farmer. The Department is geared to serve the public in many ways. In doing so it has grown into a large and complex organization. You, as an employee of the Department, have a real and challenging part, not only in your particular job, but in the general programs and objectives of the Department. Do not let the detail of your immediate

job make you forget the over-all picture and great objectives of the Department—it is an organization which holds great opportunities for advancement and personal satisfaction of worth-while work well done.



EMPLOYEE ACTIVITIES

USDA clubs.—Employees in many localities have organized USDA clubs as a means of keeping posted on the broad phases of our agricultural program and developing personal acquaintance among workers in the various Department bureaus and agencies. Speakers are scheduled for club meetings. Committees on education and training, public relations, employee welfare, and other activities carry out whatever club program meets the needs of the locality concerned. Newcomers have received friendly services—such as aid on housing problems—through the clubs. Locations of USDA clubs throughout the United States are shown on the map on page 4 of the cover of this pamphlet.

Welfare association.—In Washington there is an employee welfare association, which manages the cafeterias, provides financial assistance to employees in case of emergency, and assists general employee activities. There is a full-time recreation director who will help you plan your leisure-time activities, if you wish. Facilities and services of this organization are developed to meet the needs and interests of employees.



Credit union.—While you can participate in many employee-security plans, your savings are your first and best line of defense against emergency. The best of the benefit plans can cover only part of the expenses and debts that pile up during a streak of misfortune. Credit unions have therefore been set up both in Washington and at headquarters cities in the field. Members

save money by purchasing shares and may borrow if the credit committee approves the loan application. Loans are made to employees for many purposes and may be repaid in small monthly installments with a low rate of interest. Employees having financial difficulties are encouraged to utilize this service. Your personnel office has additional information regarding these facilities.

Professional societies.—Membership in professional societies provides employees an opportunity for mingling socially and exchanging ideas for the advancement of both employee and the Department.

Many of these societies publish journals and monographs which help members to keep up with the latest developments in their field of work.

Employee organizations.—Various national-employee associations have units in the Department of Agriculture. These organizations seek to protect job interests of employees; they assist in the formulation of personnel policies and practices; and they participate to some extent in civic and recreational problems of employees.

You are free to join or refrain from joining these associations as you wish. The Department personnel policy in appendix II of this handbook gives specific guarantee on this point in paragraph 11.

Of course, relationships in Government where we are all fellow employees in the public service, subject to laws enacted by Congress, differ greatly from relationships in private industry. For example, an employee may not be a member of an organization of Government employees that asserts the right to strike against the Government.

Leisure-time activities.—Since you're a member of a Government team that's doing a job you'll want to do the best job you can. That means you'll want to keep yourself physically fit. Recreation will help keep you feeling fit.

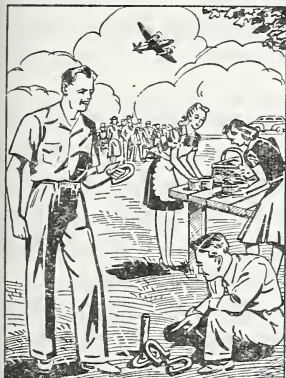
Even an 8-hour workday and a prescribed amount of sleep leaves us spare time. We should plan to use this leisure time intelligently. Many plan their leisure as carefully as they do their work.

In most bureaus, group activities are organized by members of the Department. They include bowling, dances, little-theater

groups, athletic teams, glee clubs and choruses, orchestras, and camera clubs in a wide variety of activities to meet the needs of all employees.

Churches, fraternal orders, and civic and charitable organizations also sponsor activities around which many of our employees plan their hours of leisure. Announcements are usually posted on bulletin boards or displayed in cafeterias. Additional information may be obtained from your supervisor or personnel office.

The foundation of what you will do when you retire is laid during these leisure hours—plan them wisely.



HELPFUL DAILY HINTS



Telephone manners.—How we answer the phone is so important that we have a special guidebook, telephone manners (don't miss the illustrations). Highlights: Answer promptly, pleasantly, accurately—don't pass the buck, have pad and pencil ready for notes, and return calls. Keep the lines free. If a line is busy, try again later, if the person you want is talking on another phone, ask that he call you back. Outside calls increase the Department telephone bill, so we make as few of them as possible. Except in emergencies, personal calls should not be made over official telephones.

Correspondence Style Manual.—The Correspondence Style Manual (Administrative Series No. 2) is the official guide on correspondence, it explains such details as when to use memos and when to use letter form, how to set them up, how to address envelopes. Make certain that letters are prepared for the signature of the correct person in each case and are directed to the correct person and bureau.

Records and reports.—To check progress and keep each other informed, periodic reports are prepared by each section or division, usually once a month. Reports call for less memory work if secretaries and executives keep a tally of daily happenings.

After study and circulation, reports, supporting papers, and correspondence go into the files. The only purpose in filing a paper is to be able to find it again, usually in a hurry. Bureaus and offices use various record systems; the Secretary's Record Section in Washington uses a subject numeric system. Department records have often proved unexpectedly valuable; for instance, when rubber became a critical material, folders on guayule and Brazilian rubber provided the desired information. Needless to say, we do not discuss with outsiders the contents of materials in the files.



Clearance and approval.—In an organization as large as the Department of Agriculture, it is always possible that two or three sections of widely separated bureaus may be interested in the same matter and duplicate each other's work. To avoid this, a careful system of clearance has been devised to assure a review of

new projects and manuscripts by all groups likely to be interested. Suggestions for printed forms, for instance, are studied carefully in the Office of Information, through which all printing clears, to make certain that the smallest number of forms serve the greatest number of needs.

Research projects are all reviewed by the Office of the Research Administrator. Radio speeches and many press releases must be cleared with the Office of Information. Careful plans must be made for such clearance, and time allowed for it. On recurring problems, joint committees are set up to expedite action, save time, and save the Government money. Some people regard these review devices as "red tape," but actually such devices assure expert advice and collaboration.

The mail.—People who write letters to the Government expect prompt, courteous, and complete replies. Often a single letter requires attention from several divisions or bureaus, and the reply must be approved by all interested agencies before it receives the appropriate signature.

Most Department letters go out under the official penalty-mail privilege and must therefore conform to standards set up by law. Bureaus often have control or review clerks who check official mail just before it goes out, to make certain it contains no references to personal business. They also check enclosures and addresses. Letters tend to pile up at the end of the day, so it helps to get mail off early and to send letters a few at a time as they are ready. Personal mail and telegrams should not be sent to offices except in emergencies.

Run-stop mail deliveries.—In Washington, there is a special Official Mail and Messenger Service through which mail may be sent to other Government agencies located within the District of Columbia without payment of postage. This mail must be clearly addressed, indicating the "run" and "stop" numbers of the agency to which it is going.

Be sure that you do not use envelopes, labels, or wrappers bearing the usual penalty stamp for mail to be sent through OMMS. Call Secretary's Records Section to get a copy of OMMS Revised Index No. 10, dated March 1, 1949, which gives a complete listing of appropriate run and stop numbers for nearby Government agencies.

Supplies, economy.—We requisition paper, carbon, envelopes, and other essentials from the central supply office on forms provided for the purpose, usually through our bureau business office. The Government has a list of available items with approximate prices, and each division is charged for the materials it receives. The central supply office prefers occasional good-size orders to a succession of small ones. We try not to accumulate items, and anything which we no longer want is sent back—someone else may need it. In each office one person usually takes care of supplies.

We try to run our Department economically. Electricity is power—we turn off the lights when we go out to lunch or leave the office for even a few minutes. We take care of our typewriters. We try to avoid unnecessary copies and wasted carbons. The backs of “dead mimeographing” make good scrap and rough-copy paper. Orderly supply cabinets help.

Office housekeeping.—Clean, orderly offices and buildings make a favorable impression on visitors, speed work, reduce fatigue. The cleaning force needs all its time for real scrubbing and dusting. We therefore make use of scrap baskets and waste containers, keep paper picked up, chairs in place. Notice to smokers: Use the ashtray, not the floor, never the waste-paper basket, or window.

Regulations.—The Administrative Regulations of the Department which we refer to in several places in this handbook are the rules by which you work. They are binding on members of the Department. You should become acquainted with the regulations affecting your work and conduct. The two chapters of the regulations carried in appendix II of this handbook are included for your convenience. They will help you to know the Department’s policy with respect to its employees, as well as your obligations and privileges as Department employees. In addition to the regulations, circulars, and memoranda are issued by bureau and staff offices on detailed problems and procedures. They are usually filed for reference in each office.

Across our desks come many mimeographed pages on Department business. Much of this material does not apply to your job, but some of it is essential. You will soon learn what you need to read thoroughly and what can be passed on with little scrutiny. Some pages will be marked “confidential”; remember that confidential means **CONFIDENTIAL**—don’t talk.

USDA.—The Department periodical for its members comes out twice a month and is circulated through the various offices. USDA is edited in the Office of Information and distributed by the Office of Personnel. It summarizes much policy information as well as Department happenings. USDA welcomes news and comments from readers, especially from those outside Washington with whom it is difficult to maintain steady contact. If you are not receiving USDA regularly, ask your supervisor or mail clerk for a copy.

Travel.—Government travel must be approved in advance. A special form, AD-200, Request for Authorization, is provided for this purpose. The Standardized Government Travel Regulations, which you can obtain from your bureau business office, give further details. Transportation tickets are purchased with special transportation requests; other expenses are on a reimbursement basis. If you are planning to attend a meeting outside Government as an official representative, that, too, requires special authorization.

APPENDIX I

GENERAL PUBLICATIONS

The Department of Agriculture issues numerous publications which are of individual, local, and national interest. Consequently, many mailing lists are maintained on particular subjects—an aggregate of more than 1,100 individual lists. While these publications further the interest of the bureaus in which they were prepared, their coverage is so great that many employees have found them most helpful in meeting their own interests and needs.

These publications are available in the Library, or may be secured from the Office of Information, Washington 25, D. C. The Department Library issues the monthly Bibliography of Agriculture, which is available in the larger field offices or on circulation from the main library or its branches.

SOME PUBLICATIONS ABOUT THE DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

(Available From the Department Library Under Call Numbers as Given)

THE U. S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE, ITS STRUCTURE AND FUNCTIONS. Arthur P. Chew. Explains what the various agencies and bureaus do, how, why, and where. U. S. Dept. Agr. Misc. Pub. 88. 242 pages. (1 Ag84M No. 88, revised 1940). Kept up to date by mimeographed statement on the ORIGIN, STRUCTURE, AND FUNCTIONS OF THE DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE issued at frequent intervals. U. S. Dept. Agr., Office of Information. USDA Document No. 1 (1.914 A2 or 4).

USDA, MANAGER OF AMERICAN AGRICULTURE. Ferdie Deering. Critical study of the work of the Department. University of Oklahoma Press, Norman, Oklahoma. 213 pages. 1945 (281.12 D36).

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE FUNCTIONAL ORGANIZATION CHARTS. Up to date, graphic view of all agencies of the Department. Charts revised frequently (1.917 A2 F962).

For the act of Congress in 1862 which established the Department of Agriculture, see U. S. STATUTES AT LARGE. Vol. 12, p. 387, May 15, 1862 (L 1.1 vol. 12 Legal Section, Lib.) also in HISTORICAL SKETCH OF THE U. S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE. Charles H. Greathouse (p. 57) (1 P96B No. 3, 2d revision, 1907) and other sources.

BIOGRAPHIES OF PERSONS IN CHARGE OF FEDERAL AGRICULTURAL WORK, 1836 TO DATE (1.914 A2 B52).

CONDENSED HISTORY OF THE USDA. Harding, Thomas Swann, Washington (1948) (USDA Document No. 4) (1.914 A2 C75).

APPENDIX II

MATERIAL NEW EMPLOYEES SHOULD STUDY AND KEEP HANDY FOR FUTURE REFERENCE

Title 8—Personnel

CHAPTER 1—POLICY

SECTION 1—DEPARTMENTAL PERSONNEL POLICY

1. *Purpose.*—(S) To do its job well, the Department of Agriculture must serve the whole people honestly, efficiently, economically, and wholeheartedly. Effective accomplishment of this calls for administration of the highest caliber at every level throughout the Department. To this end, the policies governing personnel in this Department must be positive and creative. They must be so planned and executed as to make for the most effective operation possible. They must be uniform and uniformly adhered to throughout our agencies, and in both departmental and field services. There should be a common understanding among all employees of their obligations and responsibilities, of their rights, and of their relations to each other, to the Department, and to the public which they serve. The personnel policy outlined herewith has been developed as a statement of the Department's objectives in its management of its human resources. Throughout the Department, employees at all levels and in all types of work have taken the opportunity furnished them of contributing their recommendations to the shaping of this policy. The Department's past experience and many of these suggestions taken together have gone to make up this statement of policy. Each of us who has executive and supervisory responsibility is, of course, a personnel manager and as such has the obligation of seeing that these policies are understood and carried out in his sphere of activity. What the Department of Agriculture achieves depends primarily on its employees, on the relations among them, and on the conditions under which they work.

2. *Relations of employees with the public.*—Service to the public is the primary obligation of every employee, and employees should conduct their work with this in mind. Each employee should conduct himself in such a manner as to create and maintain respect for the Department and the public service.

3. *Obligations of employees to the Department.*—Each employee is obligated to render full and effective service. Employment in the Department is not a right deriving from possession of a position but from the rendering of such service, both in quality and quantity, as justifies continuance of employment. Industry, cooperation, and loyal adherence to established departmental objectives are expected of all employees. The Department expects constructive suggestions for improvement of its work from every employee.

4. *Recruitment and placement.*—In filling vacant positions the best qualified person available will be chosen, regardless of race, sex, color, creed, political affiliation, personal sponsorship, or other extraneous considerations. With due recognition of the need for introduction of persons from outside the Department at any level, it will be the general policy of the Department to transfer and promote to vacancies persons already employed in the Department, provided their personal qualifications, training, and experience are at least equal to those of applicants from other sources. A sincere and planned effort will be made to place each employee in the work to which he is best suited and in which he will contribute most.

5. *Standards of service.*—Each employee is entitled, throughout his career in the Department, to know the full requirements of his job and the standards by which his service will be measured. It is the responsibility of each supervisor to see that adequate standards are provided.

6. *Training.*—Employee training programs will be maintained as a means of promoting effective and economical service. These programs will be designed to

help the employee become adjusted to his situation, to give the best service on the job in terms of mutually understood standards of performance and accomplishments, and to help him prepare for broader service and for advancement to work of greater responsibility. Development on the job of the abilities of employees is a major responsibility to be shared both by employees and by those who supervise their work.

7. *Safety, health, and welfare.*—Safe, sanitary, and healthful working conditions will be provided for all employees. Each employee will be expected to perform his work in such a way as to prevent damage to property or injury to himself or others. Because annual vacations are important to maintain health and efficiency, employees will be encouraged to take planned annual leaves, and supervisors should schedule work accordingly. The Department will encourage the development of and will cooperate with organized employee activities.

8. *Salaries and wages.*—Employees will receive uniform compensation for work of equal difficulty and responsibility, in accordance with whatever compensation plan applies to the class of employees concerned.

9. *Honors and awards.*—Exceptional and meritorious contributions of employees to efficient and constructive public service shall be recognized by honor awards, cash awards, within-grade promotions, letters of commendation, or other appropriate means.

10. *Conduct.*—Each report of neglect of duty or commission of irregularity, which if true would result in disciplinary action, shall be thoroughly investigated and judged on its merits. In cases where charges of misconduct, irregularity, or neglect of duty are made, the employee concerned will be given full opportunity to answer such charges. The Department recognizes the principle of equal penalties for offenses of similar gravity.

11. *Membership in employee and other organizations.*—Unless forbidden by law, every employee has the right to join or to refrain from joining any organization or association of employees. In the exercise of this right, they shall be free from all restraint, interference and coercion on the part of administrative and supervisory personnel or other employees. Recognition of this right, of course, is not to be construed as recognition of the right of an employee of this Department to strike, since a strike or a resort to any other form of work stoppage against the Government on the part of an employee is forbidden to him by law as totally incompatible with the methods and purposes of democratic government.

12. *Grievances.*—The Department wants employees to give frank expression of their complaints. Supervisors whenever possible will adjust employees' grievances promptly and satisfactorily. The Department will maintain a system for the appealing of employees' grievances and all employees are privileged to use this machinery without reprisal.

13. *Political activity.*—Employees are expected to conform to the spirit as well as to the letter of all applicable laws, rules, and regulations prohibiting, restricting, or governing their participation in political management, campaigns, elections, and the holding of public office.

14. *Retirement.*—The Department encourages the use of all provisions of the present retirement system to the mutual advantage of the public service and employees. Employees who are prevented from rendering satisfactory service by physical or mental disability will be recommended for retirement. The Department will constantly strive for a liberal retirement system as a fitting climax to a fruitful career in public service.

15. *Supplementary instructions.*—The Director of Personnel will issue necessary supplemental instructions.

16. *Distribution of this statement.*—Arrangements should be made for each present and new employee to be given a copy of this statement (S).

CHAPTER 45—PERSONNEL RELATIONS APPEALS PROCEDURE

Section 1—General

1610. *Purpose.*—The purpose of this chapter is to provide an orderly procedure for the adjudication of the problems, complaints, and grievances of employees.

1611. *Policy—*a. *Effective personnel relations.*—It is a part of good personnel administration that employees have access to responsible administrative officials for the discussion of individual problems affecting their status and welfare. In an organization as large as this Department, it is natural that questions and problems will arise involving personnel relations. Their prompt and orderly consideration and disposition are consistent equally with efficient administration and the desire of employees.

b. *Uniform procedures.*—It is desirable that uniform procedures be expressed and followed that will be fair, orderly, and expeditious. The procedures set forth herein apply to all employees of this Department wherever located.

c. *Employee alternatives.*—Normally, employees are expected to follow the channels established under this procedure. However, if in the employee's opinion, he finds it necessary or desirable, he may request an interview directly with any appropriate official without going through all of the steps outlined in section 4 of this chapter.

d. *Work relationships.*—What the Department of Agriculture achieves depends primarily on its employees, on the relations among them, on the conditions under which they work, and on a common understanding among all employees of their obligations and responsibilities, their rights, and their relations to each other, to the Department, and to the public which they serve.

1612. *Authority.*—The procedures outlined in this chapter are in conformance with the basic regulations on grievance procedure in Federal agencies, which appear in section 6 of Executive Order No. 7916, dated June 24, 1928. This Executive order fixes the responsibility of the Director of Personnel to establish grievance procedures subject to the approval of the head of the agency and the Civil Service Commission.

Section 2—Matters Appealable Under This Procedure

1618. *Coverage.*—In general, employees of the Department may appeal any matter coming within the administrative discretion of officials of the Department, except those matters specifically covered by existing laws or regulations. Problems, complaints, and grievances that are appealable under this procedure may involve among other things:

- a. Working conditions;
- b. Interpretation or application of rules and regulations or decisions resulting therefrom, or;
- c. Unfair treatment, including coercion, discrimination, restraint, or reprisal.

Section 3—Matters Not Appealable Under This Procedure

1624. *Matters not appealable due to legal or administrative limitations.*—Appeals will not be heard under this procedure on matters for which other appeals machinery has been established or for which no administrative discretion is allowed such as:

a. *Reduction in force and removals.*—Appeals may be made directly to the Civil Service Commission if the employee feels that proper procedures have not been followed in matters such as reduction in force and removals.

b. *Efficiency ratings.*—Efficiency ratings may be appealed to the agency efficiency rating committee and/or to the Efficiency Rating Board of Review for the Department of Agriculture, United States Civil Service Commission, Washington 25, D. C. Full information concerning these appeals may be found in the Efficiency Rating Manual.

c. *Classification appeals.*—Classification appeals should be taken up first with the immediate supervisor and then through established channels to the agency personnel office. If prompt action is not obtainable, a request may be made directly to the Office of Personnel. Departmental employees may appeal from the Office of Personnel to the Civil Service Commission. However, final decisions on classification appeals on the field service are made by the Office of Personnel. More complete information concerning this may be secured from paragraph 112 et seq., this title.

1625. *Veterans' appeals.*—Veterans have the right of further appeal to the Civil Service Commission under section XIV, Veterans' Preference Act.

Section 4—Informal Discussion and Adjustment

1630. *Employee privileged to request interview.*—Whenever any employee of the Department feels he has a problem, complaint, or grievance, he should feel free to request an interview with his supervisor or any other appropriate official.

1631. *Consideration of appeals and channels to be followed.*—Employees and officials are expected to exhaust harmoniously every administrative device to settle amicably all differences of opinion. In the interest of uniform procedure and to expedite handling, employees are expected normally to present their problems, complaints, or grievances through regular supervisory channels in the following order: The employee's immediate supervisor, proceeding then through the unit, section, or division head, as the case may be, to the head of the agency

in which employed or to such representatives as the head of the agency may designate for the purpose.

1632. *Time granted agency for adjustment.*—The head of the agency should endeavor to adjudicate the grievance by any means he feels necessary in order to minimize the need for formal procedures outlined below. The head of the agency will be granted 10 working days from the date the employee brings his grievance to his attention to attempt this adjustment.

1633. *Assistance to employee by Office of Personnel.*—If, at any stage of this informal procedure, information or assistance is needed by the employee, such assistance will be provided by the Director of Personnel or such members of his staff as are specifically designated by him.

1634. *Presentation of appeal.*—Problems, complaints, or grievances may be presented either orally or in writing.

Section 5—Formal Appeal and Adjustment

1640. *Appeal to head of agency*—a. *Submission of appeal.*—If, in the employee's opinion, reasonably prompt and satisfactory adjustment is not secured through supervisory channels, referred to in section 4 of this chapter, the employee or his representative may appeal to the head of the agency to which the employee is assigned for a hearing before a board of appeals, and he shall submit at the same time the name of the board member that he is entitled to appoint to the board. Notice of the appeal shall be presented in writing and shall state as clearly as possible the issue or cause of action and the pertinent facts as they exist in the opinion of the employee, which statement may be amended subsequently as necessary. It shall be presented in duplicate. Prompt acknowledgment of the receipt of such appeal shall be made to the employee by the head of the agency who shall also promptly send a duplicate copy of the notice of appeal to the Director of Personnel.

b. *Organization of the board to hear the appeal.*—When the head of the agency receives notice of appeal, he or his designated representative shall proceed to the organization of a board of three members to investigate the case, report findings of fact, and make recommendations for a decision. This board shall consist of the member named by the employee in his notice of appeal and a member to be selected by the head of the agency within 5 working days of receipt of the notice of appeal. These two members shall agree upon a third member within 10 working days after receipt of the notice of appeal. If these two members are unable within the 10-day period to agree upon a third member who is willing to serve on the board, the board shall automatically be dissolved, and the employee and the head of the agency concerned shall each appoint a different person as members within 5 working days after dissolution of the board. If they are still unable to agree, within 10 additional working days, the two members of the board shall then immediately notify the Director of Personnel who shall select the third impartial member of said board. Membership on the board shall be confined to employees of the executive branch of the Federal Government.

c. *Board procedure.*—Appeal boards have full authority pertaining to board procedure unless otherwise stated. Any evidence received or considered by one member must be made available to all members of the board. All statements shall become part of board hearings and there shall be no "off the record" statements. All documents resulting from hearings are considered official and copies are not to be furnished the employee or his representative. However, the complete file shall be made available for review by the employee or his representative. This board shall hear witnesses as necessary including any suggested by the employee, and shall conduct its inquiry expeditiously and in such a way as may be necessary to obtain a clear understanding of the facts. Appeals should be considered during the regular working hours of the Department.

d. *Board findings and decisions.*—Within 15 working days after its selection, the board shall report its findings and make its recommendations which shall be given careful consideration by the head of the agency in arriving at his decision. This decision shall be made within 10 working days after receipt of the findings of facts and recommendations. The employee shall be notified in writing of the decision of the head of the agency and a copy of such decision shall be sent to the Director of Personnel together with a summary of the findings of the board.

1641. *New evidence.*—If an employee introduces new evidence at any time after the first written decision is made, it shall be submitted to the Director of Personnel for determination as to whether the case shall be reopened. In instances in which a case is reopened, the Director may reconvene the old board or direct the establishment of a new board.

1642. *Appeal to Director of Personnel*—a. *Submission of appeal*.—In case the employee is dissatisfied with the decision rendered by the head of the agency, he or his representative may appeal from that decision to the Director of Personnel of the Department. Written notice of the appeal of the decision, containing a full statement of the reasons for appeal, must be filed in duplicate with the Director within 10 working days of receipt of the decision of the head of the agency. The Director shall make prompt acknowledgment of the receipt of the appeal to the employee and shall transmit the duplicate copy of the appeal to the head of the agency concerned.

b. *Method of adjudication*.

(1) *Consideration of appeal*.—When the Director receives notice of appeal, he shall seek, by any and all means, to obtain a prompt and satisfactory adjustment. He may decide the case on the basis of a thorough examination of the written reports and records or secure such additional information as he deems necessary. He may also order an investigation.

(2) *Organization of new board*.—If the Director determines it is necessary, he shall proceed to the organization of a new board of three members. This board shall consist of one member to be selected by the head of the agency concerned, one by the employee, and one by the Director. This board shall be authorized to review the records in the case and investigate the facts as necessary. The findings and recommendations of the board shall be submitted in writing to the Director within 15 working days after the board has been named.

(3) *Decision*.—The employee shall be notified of the Director's decision in writing and a copy of the decision shall be transmitted to the head of the agency concerned.

1643. *Appeal to Secretary of Agriculture*.—Employees may appeal in writing from the decision of the Director of Personnel to the Secretary of Agriculture within 10 working days of receipt of the Director's decision.

Section 6—General Information—Appeals Procedure

1649. *Responsibility*.—Individuals concerned with problems, complaints, or grievances are held responsible for carrying out the appeals procedure and promptly adjudicating matters coming within its scope. When requested, employees are asked to cooperate with officials and fellow employees in assisting them by serving as:

- a. Members of appeal boards;
- b. Witnesses before appeal boards;
- c. Employee representatives before appeal boards.

With the exception of the witnesses who may be called, individuals chosen to serve on these boards should be selected in such a manner as to preclude any one who may have formulated a definite opinion regarding the case. This includes any person who may have previously made an administrative decision in connection with the case or might, in the future, be called upon to make decisions.

1650. *Appeal by former employees*.—Former employees of the Department are not entitled to appeal under this procedure. Pending appeals will be dropped when an employee's appointment is terminated. However, if the employee wishes to continue his appeal, his case should be referred to the Director of Personnel who will determine upon the merits of the case whether or not the appeal should be completed.

1651. *Time limits*.—All time limits stated in this procedure will be adhered to unless exception is granted by the Director of Personnel or a member of his staff designated to act for him.

1652. *Expenses*.—If appropriations permit, travel expenses may be authorized for employees whose presence is determined necessary by the board in connection with these hearings. All expenses incident to travel or otherwise incurred in the board hearings shall be borne by the agency in which the appellant is employed. Time spent on appeals is official duty. It is the policy of the Department to have boards of appeal convene in or as close as possible to the localities where the appellants and witnesses reside. The Department cannot legally incur travel or other expenses for personnel of other Federal agencies or of persons not in the Federal service who are called upon to participate in hearings.

1653. *Reprisals or coercion prohibited*.—It is to be clearly understood that any employee shall be free from any and all restraint, interference, coercion, or reprisal on the part of his associates or supervisors in making any appeal, in serving as an employee's representative, in serving on an appeals board, in appearing as a witness or in seeking information in accordance with these procedures. The above principles apply as well after a complaint, grievance, or problem is adjudicated. Should these principles be violated, the facts shall be brought to

the attention of the Director of Personnel immediately by any employee in the Department and they shall be investigated with a view toward the imposition of such disciplinary measures as the facts warrant.

1654. *Function of Office of Personnel.*—The Office of Personnel of the Department has, as one of its functions, the responsibility for matters pertaining to employee grievances, complaints, and related subjects. Employees located in Washington are at liberty to consult with members of the staff at any time they have failed to obtain satisfaction through the official channels of their own agency. Field employees may communicate directly by letter with the Director of Personnel.

1655. *Distribution.*—Arrangements should be made for each new employee to be given a copy of this chapter.

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE,
OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY,
Washington 25, D. C., December 13, 1948.

FAIR EMPLOYMENT PRACTICES

MEMORANDUM TO HEADS OF DEPARTMENT AGENCIES

After thorough discussion with interested groups, I have decided on several principles and procedures for enforcement of Executive Order 9980 concerning fair employment practices in the Government service.

The Department of Agriculture has had, for some time, an established policy forbidding discrimination for any reason whatsoever, including race, sex, color, creed, political affiliation, or personal sponsorship. The Department has also recognized for many years the rights of employees to appeal the decisions of their superiors. Procedures to carry out this policy, which apply to employees in the field service as well as to those in Washington, have been issued in the Administrative Regulations (8AR ch. 45).

It seems sensible to bring under existing procedure actions which may arise under Executive Order 9980, rather than establish new machinery for carrying out this order. Therefore, whenever possible any grievance pertaining to discrimination in employment should be conducted as if it involved any other subject of grievance.

It should be noted that this procedure differs from that outlined in 8AR chapter 45 in the following ways:

1. Appeals under this Executive order will be accepted not only from employees of the Department, but also from persons who contend they have failed to receive appointment or have been terminated because of race, religion, color, or national origin.

2. Appeals should be filed within 30 days of the date the appellant learns of the alleged discrimination and not later than 6 months from the date of the personnel action concerning which complaint is made. Appeals may be filed orally or in writing with the first-line supervisor or head of the agency, but appeals from this decision and subsequent decisions must be in writing. Copies of any previous decisions must accompany further appeals. For the purposes of this order, the head of the agency shall be considered to be a deputy fair employment officer.

3. Anyone desiring to appeal the decision of the head of the agency appeals to the fair employment officer instead of to the Director of Personnel. This appeal must be made within 10 days.

4. The decision of the Secretary of Agriculture may be appealed within 10 days to the Fair Employment Board of the Civil Service Commission.

5. Any person appealing on the grounds of discrimination shall have the following additional rights which are not now specifically provided in the appeal procedure:

- a. A representative present to assist him with his appeal or defense. (This representative will be in addition to the board members.)

- b. Verbatim transcript of all testimony, a copy of which shall be made available to the complainant.

- c. Cross-examination of any person testifying before the board.

Nothing in this memorandum or in the appeals procedure shall preclude any employee who feels that he has a grievance within the scope of Executive Order 9980 from appealing directly to me, as the Department fair employment officer, or to my alternate, Stanley Williams, of the Secretary's office.

Please bring this memorandum and Executive Order 9980, which is attached, to the attention of each employee in your agency.

Attachment.

WESLEY McCUNE,
Executive Assistant to the Secretary.

EXECUTIVE ORDER 9980

REGULATIONS GOVERNING FAIR EMPLOYMENT PRACTICES WITHIN THE FEDERAL ESTABLISHMENT

Whereas the principles on which our Government is based require a policy of fair employment throughout the Federal establishment, without discrimination because of race, color, religion, or national origin; and

Whereas it is desirable and in the public interest that all steps be taken necessary to insure that this long-established policy shall be more effectively carried out: Now, therefore, by virtue of the authority vested in me as President of the United States, by the Constitution and the laws of the United States, it is hereby ordered as follows:

1. All personnel actions taken by Federal appointing officers shall be based solely on merit and fitness; and such officers are authorized and directed to take appropriate steps to insure that in all such actions there shall be no discrimination because of race, color, religion, or national origin.

2. The head of each department in the executive branch of the Government shall be personally responsible for an effective program to insure that fair-employment policies are fully observed in all personnel actions within his department.

3. The head of each department shall designate an official thereof as fair employment officer. Such officer shall be given full operating responsibility, under the immediate supervision of the department head, for carrying out the fair-employment policy herein stated. Notice of the appointment of such officer shall be given to all officers and employees of the department. The fair employment officer shall, among other things—

(a) Appraise the personnel actions of the department at regular intervals to determine their conformity to the fair-employment policy expressed in this order.

(b) Receive complaints or appeals concerning personnel actions taken in the department on grounds of alleged discrimination because of race, color, religion or national origin.

(c) Appoint such central or regional deputies, committees, or hearing boards, from among the officers or employees of the department, as he may find necessary or desirable on a temporary or permanent basis to investigate, or to receive, complaints of discrimination.

(d) Take necessary corrective or disciplinary action, in consultation with, or on the basis of delegated authority from the head of the department.

4. The findings or action of the fair employment officer shall be subject to direct appeal to the head of the department. The decision of the head of the department on such appeal shall be subject to appeal to the Fair Employment Board of the Civil Service Commission, hereinafter provided for.

5. There shall be established in the Civil Service Commission a Fair Employment Board (hereinafter referred to as the Board) of not less than seven persons, the members of which shall be officers or employees of the Commission. The Board shall—

(a) Have authority to review decisions made by the head of any department which are appealed pursuant to the provisions of this order, or referred to the Board by the head of the department for advice and to make recommendations to such head. In any instance in which the recommendation of the Board is not promptly and fully carried out the case shall be reported by the Board to the President, for such action as he finds necessary.

(b) Make rules and regulations, in consultation with the Civil Service Commission, deemed necessary to carry out the Board's duties and responsibilities under this order.

(c) Advise all departments on problems and policies relating to fair employment.

(d) Disseminate information pertinent to fair-employment programs.

(e) Coordinate the fair-employment policies and procedures of the several departments.

(f) Make reports and submit recommendations to the Civil Service Commission for transmittal to the President from time to time, as may be necessary to the maintenance of the fair-employment program.

6. All departments are directed to furnish to the Board all information needed for the review of personnel actions or for the compilation of reports.

7. The term "department" as used herein shall refer to all departments and agencies of the executive branch of the Government, including the Civil Service Commission. The term "personnel action," as used herein, shall include failure

to act. Persons failing of appointment who allege a grievance relating to discrimination shall be entitled to the remedies herein provided.

8. The means of relief provided by this order shall be supplemental to those provided by existing statutes, Executive orders, and regulations. The Civil Service Commission shall have authority, in consultation with the Board, to make such additional regulations, and to amend existing regulations, in such manner as may be found necessary or desirable to carry out the purposes of this order.

HARRY S. TRUMAN.

THE WHITE HOUSE,

July 26, 1948.

(Federal Register July 28, 1948.)

WHEN ACCIDENTS STRIKE

The Injured's *Bill of Rights*

If a civil employee of the United States sustains an injury "while in the performance of duty," such employee is entitled to:

Medical care.—Included are medical, surgical, and hospital services and supplies; also transportation if travel is necessary to secure them. Treatment must be obtained from United States medical officers and hospitals, if practicable. If these are not available, use physicians designated by the Bureau of Employees' Compensation. Duly qualified private physicians may be used only if governmental or designated medical facilities are not available. First consult your immediate superior for listings.

Money benefits.—If disabled for work, compensation begins on the fourth day of disability, or if leave with pay is taken, on the fourth day after pay stops. Benefits continue throughout the entire period of disability.

Q. What if I am totally disabled?—A. You receive, as defined below, two-thirds of your monthly pay as long as you are totally disabled. If permanently and totally disabled, benefits continue for life; and should your condition require a constant attendant, an additional \$50 per month may be allowed.

Q. How much can I get in any one month?—A. The most you can get is \$116.66, exclusive of funds provided for an attendant. The least you will receive is \$58.33, unless your pay is less, in which case you will receive your full pay. Monthly pay includes the money received for your services and also the value of subsistence and quarters, if furnished.

Q. Suppose I am only partially disabled?—A. Benefits are then payable on the basis of two-thirds of your loss of wage-earning capacity. If such loss is for life, payments are likewise for life.

Q. And if I am killed in line of duty?—A. Your family is adequately protected. Your wife for the remainder of her widowhood, your children until they marry or reach 18 years of age. A wife is entitled to 35 percent of the husband's monthly pay; each child 10 percent. If the wife is dead, the first child receives 25 percent, each additional child 10 percent. However, the maximum monthly wage upon which such benefits are computed is \$175. The maximum a widow can receive is \$61.25 per month. The maximum payment to all dependents is \$116.66 per month.

Q. Is a husband entitled to benefits for the occupational death of his wife?—A. Yes, provided he is wholly dependent upon the deceased. Compensation benefits are also payable to dependent parents, brothers, sisters, grandparents, and grandchildren. Payments cease upon death or marriage; and in the case of a brother or sister, upon reaching 18 years of age.

Q. What about burial expenses in case of death?—A. Burial expenses not to exceed \$200 are payable in any individual case. Transportation of the body to its former residence in the United States is provided where an employee dies away from the home station.

Q. Are occupational diseases covered by the Compensation Act?—A. Any bona fide occupational disease is compensable.

What to do

1. **Know your rights** under the compensation law. Keep this notice along with your other valuable papers. You, your family, and your family's future may be dependent upon a thorough knowledge of it.

2. *Report every occupational injury* to your immediate official superior without delay. If others were present at the time of your accident, get their names as witnesses.

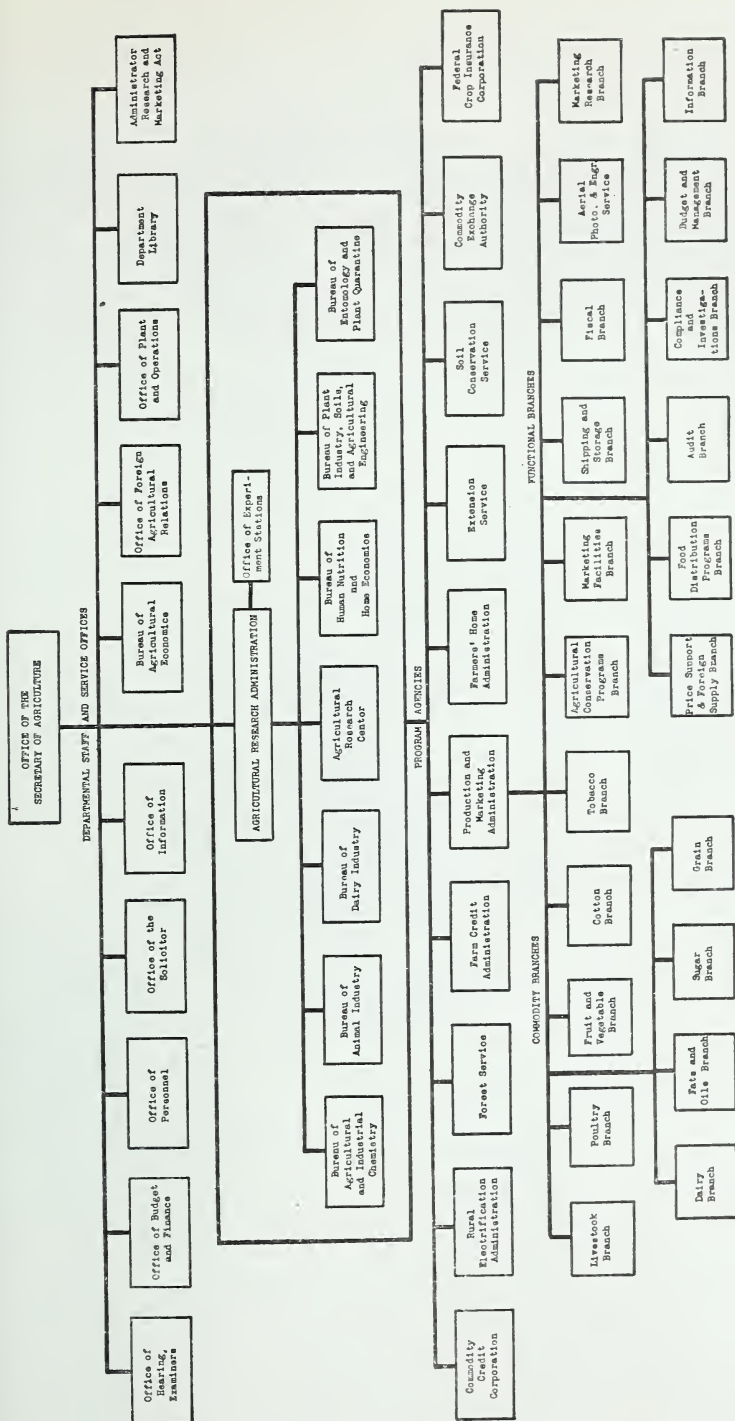
3. *Secure first-aid treatment first.*—Infection is painful and costly to you. Even under compensation you lose at least one-third of your pay check.

4. *Consult your supervisor* for the proper forms needed to secure adequate medical treatment, and to file a notice of injury, Form CA-1.

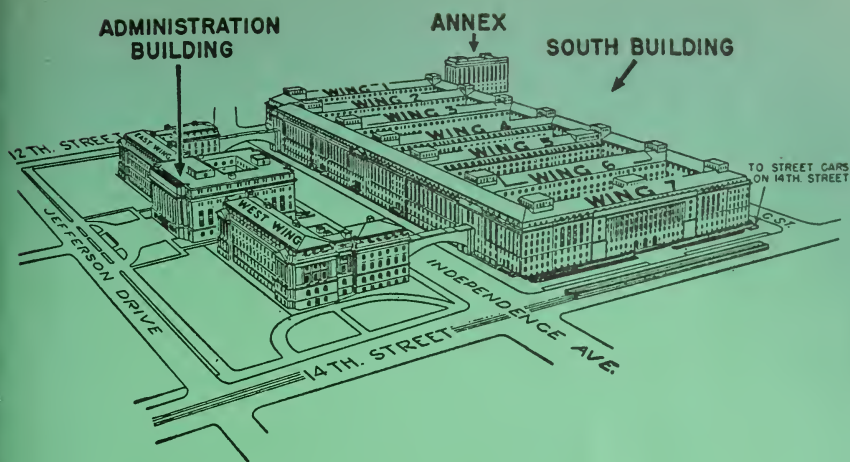
5. *Claim Form CA-4* for compensation should be submitted promptly whenever any loss of pay is involved. Although technically you may have a year in which to present a claim, the payment you're interested in is dependent upon prompt completion of Form CA-4. No compensation is paid without it!

6. *A safe workman* draws full pay regularly. Avoid the accident that causes the injury, but if you are injured, abide by the rules that assure full protection to yourself and your family.

WHEN IN DOUBT about your rights under compensation law write to the Federal Security Agency, Bureau of Employees' Compensation.







U. S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE WASHINGTON, D. C.

1. The Bureau of Engraving streetcar brings you to the Department of Agriculture. Any streetcar in the tunnel, which is located at Fourteenth and C Streets SW., will take you to the business section of Washington.

2. South Building.—Any office may be located by applying the following information: All four-figure rooms are in the South Building. The first figure indicates the floor (basement 0); the second, the wing (0 as the second of the four figures denote Independence Avenue corridor; 8 or 9, the C Street corridor); the third and fourth the room number.

Administration Building.—Rooms have three figures, except those in the basement which have two. W and E refer to the west and east wings; rooms without letters are in the center Administration Building.

The two buildings are joined by bridges on the third floor and by a tunnel east of center in the basement.

3. There are three cafeterias on the sixth floor of the South Building. Two of these are on the C Street side. One can be reached by taking the elevator on the C Street end of the fourth wing; the other, by taking the elevator on the C Street end of the sixth wing. The third cafeteria is in the fifth wing and can be reached by taking the elevator on the Independence Avenue end of the fifth wing. The Welfare Store is in the basement of the center section of the Administration Building.

U.S.D.A. CLUB LOCATIONS

* FARM CREDIT CLUB DEPARTMENT-WIDE MEETINGS
 ** MEMBERSHIP DRAWN FROM NEARBY VICINITIES

BOSTON
 NEW YORK
 NEW BRUNSWICK
 PHILADELPHIA
 PITTSBURGH
 HARRISBURG
 NORFOLK
 RICHMOND
 BALTIMORE
 PHILADELPHIA
 CINCINNATI
 MORGANTOWN
 COLUMBUS
 COLUMBIA
 CHARLESTON
 SAVANNAH
 JACKSONVILLE
 ORLANDO
 JACKSON
 MOBILE
 GULFPORT
 NEW ORLEANS
 HOUMA
 BATON ROUGE
 HOUSTON
 SAN ANTONIO
 DALLAS
 FORT WORTH
 OKLAHOMA CITY
 ALBUQUERQUE
 AMARILLO
 DENVER
 PUEBLO**
 SALT LAKE CITY**
 BOISE
 PORTLAND
 YAKIMA
 SPOKANE
 TACOMA**
 SOUTHERN PUGET SOUND
 VANCOUVER
 SEATTLE
 FARGO-MOORHEAD
 BISMARCK-MANDAN
 MINNEAPOLIS-ST. PAUL
 MILWAUKEE
 LANSING
 DETROIT
 CHICAGO
 AMES
 SIoux CITY
 CHEYENNE
 SCOTT'SBLUFF
 OMAHA
 LINCOLN
 ST. JOSEPH
 KANSAS CITY
 ST. LOUIS
 KANSAS CITY, Mo.
 ST. LOUIS
 KNOXVILLE
 LITTLE ROCK
 MEMPHIS
 GAINESVILLE
 ATLANTA
 MONTGOMERY
 BIRMINGHAM
 JACKSON

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**** MEMBERSHIP DRAWN FROM NEARBY VICINITIES**

● PUERTO RICO